Do Reassurance Signals Reassure? Political Ideology and Sender-Receiver Gap in Asymmetric Alliances*

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This Draft: March 3, 2026

Abstract

Conventional wisdom dictates that a patron can reassure its protégés by sending costly signals. Are reassurance signals effective for reassuring protégés? We argue that the patron's use of *opaque* reassurance signals involving military assets operated by the patron could induce a sender-receiver gap between the patron and the progressive constituents within the protégé as the latter experiences an inflated fear of entrapment. Such effects arise because of the two predispositions of progressives, namely their dovishness and the low level of trust in the patron's intentions with respect to the purpose of *opaque* reassurance signals. We test this argument on the South Korean case using a mixed-methods strategy. First, we examine how the major media outlets describe the issue of the deployment of the Terminal High Altitude Area Defense (THAAD) missiles using Structural Topic Models. Second, we reanalyze two prior experimental studies examining the effect of patron's reassurance signals on the attitude of the domestic constituents within the protégé. Third, we examine the speeches of the political elites to investigate whether progressive political elites are more likely to express the deployment of the THAAD missiles in negative terms. The findings from the three studies collectively show that certain costly reassurance signals from the patron could be counterproductive in reassuring the progressive constituents within the protégé. We also find that this divergence between progressives and conservatives does not arise with respect to *transparent* political reassurance signals. Our research has important implications for understanding the role of political ideology in asymmetric alliances and reassurance dynamics.

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Introduction

An overview of the historical accounts of security cooperation in U.S.-led alliances raises an important puzzle as to why certain factions within the U.S. protégés opposed reassurance signals from Washington while others supported them. Lake (2013, 99) notes there was "dissent on the left" in Europe with respect to Washington's security policy in Europe. For example, it is well-known that the U.S. proposal to deploy the Pershing II missiles in 1983 was highly controversial with a deep partisan divide in the Bundestag. Why do certain factions within a protégé oppose reassurance signals from the patron while others support them? Conventional wisdom suggests that reassurance signals from the patron should reassure the protégé that the former would be willing to intervene and support the latter should a contingency arise as long as the signal is sufficiently costly (e.g., Debs and Monteiro, 2017; McManus and Nieman, 2019; Blankenship, 2020). However, the above example demonstrates that the patron might sometimes fail to reassure certain factions even with sufficiently costly signals. What explains this variation in the reassurance outcomes?

This question bears both theoretical and practical significance. Scholars have long noted that the objective of costly signaling may be difficult to achieve in practice. Jervis (1970, 301) notes, "it might seem that problems of interpretation do not arise with costly signals because costs are objective and will be seen the same way by all participants. But what the actor feels to be a cost, observers may not so categorize, or vice versa." Although recent experimental research shows that costly signaling might not work as stipulated by off-the-shelf formal models (Quek, 2016; Yarhi-Milo, Kertzer and Renshon, 2018; Kertzer, Rathbun and Rathbun, 2020), scholars lack a clear understanding of *why* this might be so. We suggest

that one important factor may be political ideology. Scholars in other subfields have long recognized that political ideology, as a certain structure of "political belief system" (Sartori, 1969), influences how individuals form their worldviews. Curiously enough, there has been a lack of theoretical development in the IR scholarship on how ideology might matter for costly signaling. We provide a novel theoretical argument of how political ideology might matter in the context of reassurance in asymmetric alliances.

Our research also has implications for the current framing of the debate on reassurances in asymmetric alliances. Much of the International Relations scholarship implicitly assumes that the most important question regarding the patron's costly reassurance signals to the protégé is whether the latter can correctly infer that the patron would reliably intervene and support the protégé should contingencies arise (e.g., McManus and Nieman, 2019; Blankenship, 2020). Given that the protégé is sufficiently reassured by the costly signals from the patron, the logic goes, it would refrain from pursuing independent security policy that is misaligned with that of the patron (Morrow, 1991; Bleek and Lorber, 2014). While much of the conventional wisdom suggests that the protégé would be receptive of the patron's reassurance signals as they would strengthen deterrence against regional adversaries, we theorize and show that certain costly signals from the patron could have unintended perverse consequences certain constituents within the protégé are likely to have an inflated fear of entrapment.

We argue that different foreign policy attitudes motivated by political ideology may inhibit a significant proportion of the protégé's population from being reassured by costly signals from the patron. In particular, we argue that progressives are less likely to be re-

assured compared to conservatives.[1] Such divergence in the degree of reassurance arises because of the difference in perceptions of the patron's intentions. We theorize that progressives are less likely to be reassured by *opaque* reassurance signals involving the deployment of military assets compared to conservatives due to their dovishness and low level of trust in the patron's intentions behind the purpose of these opaque reassurance signals.

We test our theory on the South Korean case. We first show that there was a divergence in reaction between the conservative and progressive media over the issue of the deployment of the Terminal High Altitude Area Defense (THAAD) missiles. In particular, we find that the progressive media show skepticism towards reassurance signals from the patron, while the conservative media emphasize the security benefits provided by the reassurance signals. Next, we reanalyze the findings of Suh (2025) and Ko (2019) to examine whether ideology has differential effects on how individuals react to the forward deployment of nuclear weapons. We find that individuals with progressive ideology are less likely to be reassured and more likely to express support for independent nuclear weapons when exposed to the relevant treatment conditions. Lastly, we analyze the elite speeches of the National Assembly members in the "Foreign Affairs and Unification Committee" to examine how they responded to the deployment of the THAAD missiles. We find that the progressive members were more likely to express opposition to the deployment compared to their conservative counterparts. The findings from the three studies collectively support our theory that progressives have been less likely to be reassured from the costly signals sent by the patron.

The rest of the paper proceeds as follows. We first explain what we mean by reassurance signals and the state of being reassured. We then present our theory on why a sender-receiver

[1] We use the terms progressive and liberal interchangeably throughout this paper.

gap may exist between the patron and the progressive constituents within the proteégé. Next, we present our research design and our empirical findings supporting our theory. We conclude with the discussion on the limitations of our paper and suggestions for future research.

Reassurance Signals as Costly Signals

In this paper, we define reassurance as a patron's use of costly signals to communicate to the protégé that it is willing to support the protégé in case of contingencies. The main intuition behind the logic of costly signaling in the game theoretic literature is simple: if there exists a sincere type and an insincere type, and only the former is willing to pay for the costly signal to communicate its type, the receiver can update its beliefs accordingly after observing the signal from the sender (Fearon, 1997; Kydd, 2000). Past literature suggests that a patron might seek to reassure its protégé that the former is a reliable major power patron such that the latter would refrain from pursuing independent nuclear weapons or security policies that are misaligned with those of the patron. This is consistent with how past scholars conceptualize reassurance (Bleek and Lorber, 2014; Blankenship, 2020; Blankenship and Lin-Greenberg, 2022; Sukin and Lanoszka, 2024).

Since the seminal article on signaling by Fearon (1997), IR scholars have applied the concept to demonstrate how a patron could use various costly signals to reassure its allies (Sorg and Wucherpfennig, 2024; Sukin and Seo, 2024; Suh, 2025; Lee, 2025). In the process of conceptualizing these reassurance signals, however, scholars have tended to overlook one important characteristic of these signals that have important implications for the relationship between the patron and its protégés, namely the possibility of their misuse which we now elaborate.

There are two types of reassurance signals that we discuss in this paper. The first type of reassurance signals involve military assets deployed by the patron to the territory of the protégé. In practice, these signals often permit the possibility of misuse by the patron One important characteristic of these signals involving military assets is the lack of transparency in their purpose. More specifically, the constituents of the protégé can never be certain whether the purpose of these weapons is for defense/deterrence or offense. For brevity, we refer to this first type of signals as *opaque* signals.[2] Scholars have long argued that weapons designed for defensive purposes often cannot be distinguished from those designed for defensive purposes (Jervis, 1978; Mearsheimer, 2017). Such a dilemma not only exists between adversaries but also for the protégé who cannot be completely certain of the patron's intentions.[3]

The second type of reassurance signals involve political measures − rather than direct military deployment − that convey the patron's support for the protégé. In practice, these signals are relatively more transparent because it is clear that the patron aims to enhance deterrence rather than offensive capabilities, as they carry significantly little risk of being misused. As such, neither conservatives nor progressives have no reason to believe that these reassurance signals would entrap the protégé through the patron's offensive measures. For brevity, we refer to these as *transparent* reassurance signals.

[2]To be clear, by the term opaque, we are not implying that the protégé is unsure of whether the signal has been sent but rather that that there is an uncertainty in the intentions behind the signal and thus permits the possibility of misuse by the patron.

[3]It is perhaps worth noting in passing that defensive alliances do not preclude the possibility of the patron undertaking a preventive strike as the United States considered attacking North Korea multiple times (Wampler, 1997).

Sender-Receiver Gap based on Political Ideology

Concept of Reassurance in Asymmetric Alliances

What do we mean when we describe a protégé as being reassured? We define the state of being reassured as a situation in which the protégé feels secure through its co-operation with the patron. From the protégé's perspective, there are two components to reassurance, namely the mitigation of the (perceived) risks of abandonment and entrapment.[4] The first type of risk a protégé would want to mitigate is the risk of abandonment. Intuitively, a protégé would want to make sure that the patron would be willing to provide support to the protégé in times of contingencies. The second type of risk a protégé would want to mitigate is the risk of entrapment; the protégé would want to avoid situations where the patron escalates a contingency with the regional adversary against its own will. From this perspective, reassurance is a function of the perception of these two types of risks. Ideally, a perfect patron from the protégé's perspective would be one who would agree with the protégé in terms of "goals, resources, and methods" in dealing with contingencies (Henry, 2020, 52).

Admittedly, not all IR scholars conceptualize reassurance in this manner. For example, in discussing asymmetric alliances, Henry (2020) recognizes that most scholars focus only on the risk of abandonment. However, we suggest that security scholars would lack a proper understanding of the alliance dynamics if they overlook the risk of entrapment that protégés perceive in their security cooperation. As we discuss below, the fear of entrapment

[4]In this paper, we do not aim to measure the objective risks of abandonment and entrapment, but rather seek to theorize how the protégé's *perceived* risks of abandonment and entrapment affect the state of being reassured. As such, we will often use the terms *fear of abandonment* and *fear of entrapment* throughout the paper.

that protégés perceived in their relations with Washington has been an important factor in determining the alliance dynamics.

Reassurance Signals and the Fear of Abandonment

Existing studies on reassurance usually identify reassurance with mitigating the fear of abandonment (Leeds, Long and Mitchell, 2000; Blankenship, 2020; Blankenship and Lin-Greenberg, 2022). Allies make promises and seek to create mechanisms to enforce those promises. In the context of asymmetric alliances, these studies conceptualize reassurance as a patron's use of costly signals to communicate to the protégé that the former is willing to support the protégé in case of contingencies. As such, these studies suggest that the protégé is reassured when costly signals mitigate the fear of abandonment.

The patron might have multiple motivations in seeking to reassure the protégé in this regard. One obvious motivation might be to restrain the protégé from pursuing independent nuclear weapons or security policies that are misaligned with those of the patron (Bleek and Lorber, 2014; Blankenship, 2020; Blankenship and Lin-Greenberg, 2022; Sukin and Lanoszka, 2024). In practice, a patron seeks to reassure its protégé by sending either hand-tying or sunk-cost signals (Fearon, 1997). For example, McManus and Nieman (2019) identify various signals of support that major power patrons could provide to protégés, such as arms transfers, alliance pacts, and joint military exercises. Prior studies indeed suggest that reassurance signals can be effective in mitigating fears of abandonment for the protgé (e.g., Debs and Monteiro, 2017).

In this paper, we do not question that costly reassurance signals can mitigate the fear of abandonment, nor do we have *a priori* theoretical expectation to believe that there would be

a significant difference between conservatives and progressives in terms of their assessment of the patron's willingness to intervene on behalf of the protégé. The "use-it-or-lose-it" logic would dominate how the protégé perceives these signals and would thus be able to convince the protégé that the patron would intervene on behalf of the protégé and use these weapons deployed on the territory of the protégé. However, as laid out in the exposition, the risk of abandonment is only one component of reassurance. We now turn to the issue of why there is likely to be a difference between conservatives and progressives in terms of the effect of reassurance signals on the (perceived) risk of entrapment.

Reassurance Signals and the Fear of Entrapment

On the other hand, scholars have noted that progressives often have a greater fear of entrapment than conservatives (e.g., Olesen, 2018; Moller, 2022). Why would this be so? We highlight two predispositions of progressives, namely dovishness and the low level of trust in the patron's security policy, which jointly work together to explain why progressives might be less likely to be reassured compared to conservatives. First, progressives are relative more dovish compared to conservatives. There is a long line of empirical research showing that individuals with conservative ideology are likely to be more hawkish, or exhibit a greater willingness to use military force, than their progressive counterparts (Palmer, London and Regan, 2004; Arena and Palmer, 2009; Clare, 2014; Wagner et al., 2018; Bertoli, Dafoe and Trager, 2019; Onderco, Etienne and Smetana, 2022). For example, Onderco, Etienne and Smetana (2022) show that German and Dutch citizens who are more conservative are likely to express support for using nuclear weapons. Similar patterns are found at the level of leaders as well. For instance, Bertoli, Dafoe and Trager (2019) use a regression discontinuity

design to show that conservative leaders who win close elections are more likely to initiate militarized interstate disputes compared to progressive leaders.

Two points are in order with respect to the concept of hawkishness. First, being hawkish − or possessing a greater willingness to use force − does not suggest that one assesses using military force to be without cost. Rather, hawkish individuals perceive using military force as *less* costly compared to dovish individuals. Such difference in perceptions can arise even if same material costs arise from using military force to achieve a given foreign policy goal; some individuals might perceive the cost to be excessively high while others might perceive the cost to be relatively moderate.

Second, contrary to what might be commonly assumed in the International Relations literature, dovishness is *not* incompatible with support for possessing a strong military. As we have noted above, the hawkishness-dovishness dimension pertains to the use of military force rather than the buildup of military capabilities. As such, governments could seek to increase military spending for enhancing deterrence rather than intending to use such armaments to initiate military conflicts. In particular, in a high-threat security environment which threatens a nation's survival, Whitten and Williams (2011) theorize that governments would increase their military spending "regardless of ideological position." The notion that the simple hawkishness-dovishness dimension would predict military spending has been constantly refuted by various scholars (Eichenberg and Stoll, 2003; Whitten and Williams, 2011). In particular, the empirical results in Fuhrmann (2020) show that government ideology is not a statistically significant predictor of military spending.

This second point is worth emphasizing because scholars have tended to argue that doves would oppose armament buildup out of fear that such a measure would be seen as

provocative by the adversary (Rathbun et al., 2016; Sorg and Wucherpfennig, 2024). In other words, dovish individuals believe that the spiral model, rather than in the deterrence model, underlies how the security environment operates.[5] Although such a relationship might hold empirically in certain contexts, it is a mistake for scholars to conflate the degree of one's willingness to use force with whether one believes in the spiral model as these are two different orthogonal concepts. In other words, there is nothing theoretically incoherent about a dovish individual expressing support for building a strong military. As Jervis (2017, 68) notes, a "peaceful state knows that it will use its arms only to protect itself, not to harm others. It further assumes that others are fully aware of this." Similarly, a dovish individual who hold strong preferences against using force might nonetheless espouse accumulating arms to keep peace and also believe that others would perceive such measures to be motivated out of desire for peace. Thus, according to this perspective, it is plausible that a dovish individual would believe that the adversary would understand that one's increase in armament is motivated to enhance deterrence.

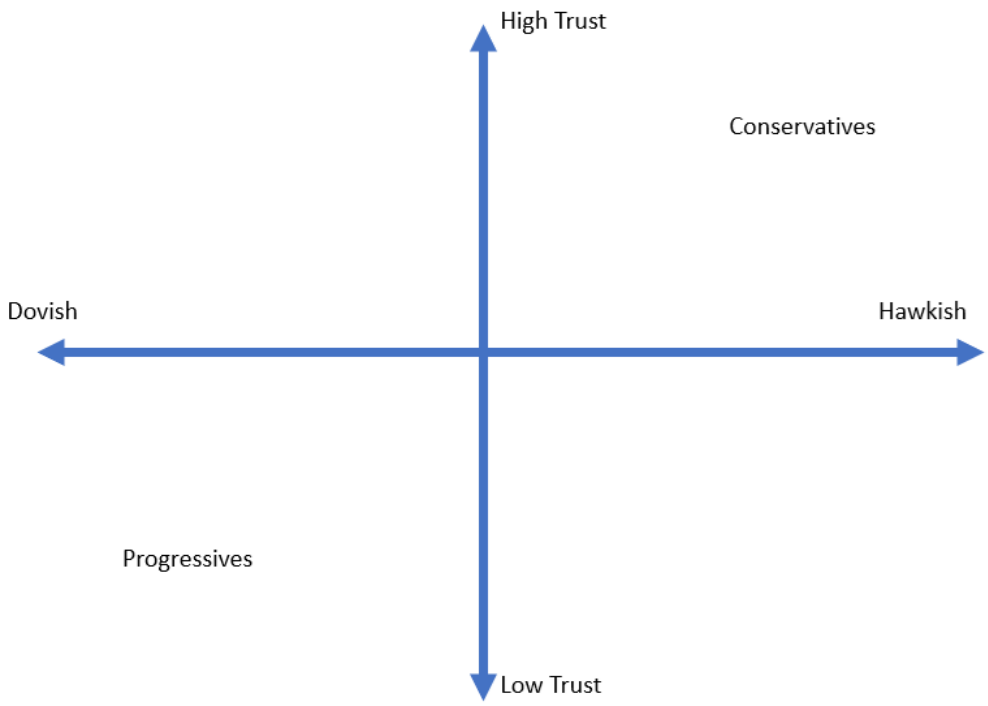
The above discussion also provides a theoretical justification for why we are able to observe left-wing governments in Europe pursuing an *active* multilateral security policy (Rapport and Rathbun, 2021). After all, if the role of armaments and strong military is to deter regional adversaries, it seems plausible that even individuals who hold dovish preferences should *support* a strong military along with an active multilateral security policy. Indeed, there is no inherent contradiction between holding dovish preferences and supporting active participation in multilateral alliances. For example, past research shows that left-wing parties are more likely than their right-wing counterparts in joining alliances in which they

[5]For the difference in these two models of worldview, refer to Jervis (2017).

can express their voice (Rapport and Rathbun, 2021).

The second predisposition of progressives that we highlight is their inclination to possess a low level of trust in the patron regarding whether the alliance commitment is solely for defensive purposes. In other words, progressives have been more likely to believe that the alliance, despite nominally being *defensive*, could be used for offensive purposes. Scholars have long argued that progressives in various contexts have been less trustful of Washington than conservatives because of various political and ideological reasons (Epstein, 1951; Schweigler, 1986; Isernia et al., 2007; Proksch, Slapin and Thies, 2011; Catalinac, 2010). Such general mistrust has often been translated to the realm of security policy as well (Catalinac, 2010; Proksch, Slapin and Thies, 2011; Olesen, 2018). In the context of security cooperation, progressives have been less likely to be trustful than conservatives in forming security ties with Washington. For example, in deciding whether to join NATO, the Social Democratic Party of Denmark was deeply suspicious of the intentions of the "United States and had an implicit fear that the United States could start a new world war, a war in which Denmark would likely become involved against its will" (Olesen, 2018, 85). Similarly, the Socialists in Iceland were concerned that the Defense Agreement with Washington would make their homeland a "launching pad for strategic attacks on the Soviet Union as part of America's "aggressive war plans"" (Ingimundarson, 2011, 63).

We now proceed to explain the implications of our theoretical framework based on Figure 1. The two predispositions of progressives jointly explain why, in the context of asymmetric alliances, progressives are likely to have a greater fear of entrapment after observing reassurance signals from the patron. Since progressives have little trust that the patron seeks to keep the status quo rather than to revise it, an *opaque* reassurance signal involving mil-



itary assets can exaggerate such fears since these could be used to initiate military strikes or escalate a military crisis against the protégé's intentions. Note that such possibilities are especially concerning for progressives since they are dovish. In contrast, conservatives are relatively more likely to be reassured by the patron's reassurance signals involving military assets since they have a high level of trust that the patron seeks to enhance deterrence through such measures and also see a relatively low cost in using force. As such, even if these military assets deployed by the patron are used for offensive means, they are less likely to view such measures as costly since they are hawkish.[6]

We now discuss the two complementary pathways through which progressives would fear entrapment. First, as discussed above, progressives are more likely to believe that the *patron* could misuse the *opaque* signal to implement an offensive attack. As noted, the protégé can

[6]Note that both of these dimensions are necessary in explaining the divergent attitudes between the conservatives and progressives. If, for example, progressives are more hawkish than conservatives, the lack of trust in the patron's security policy by itself may not make a difference since the expected cost of using force may be no more costly for progressives compared to conservatives.

never be certain of the patron's intentions and progressives are less likely to trust that the security policy of the patron is solely for defensive purposes. Under such circumstances, the patron's *opaque* reassurance signals which permit misuse are likely to engender a greater sense of entrapment resulting from the possibility of the patron initiating an offensive policy. For example, the protesters during the Pershing II controversy took their case to the court based on the argument that West Germany was preparing for an "aggressive war" in violation of the constitution (Quint, 2007, 20). Such entrapment fears were especially acute given that the protégé usually has little say in the operation of these weapons systems. As the German political scientist Peter Schlotter assessed at the time, the system essentially signified the delegation of "the decision over the annihilation of the Federal Republic to a foreign power" (Quint, 2007, 19).

Second, progressives are also more likely to believe that the *adversary* would perceive the *opaque* reassurance signals as an offensive measure and thereby be provoked into implementing a preemptive strike. Similar to the argument presented in Jervis (2017), past research in political psychology shows that individuals often overestimate the extent to which others hold worldviews and belief systems similar to their own (Steiner, Landwehr and Harms, 2026). As such, the belief that the adversary would perceive these reassurance signals as an offensive posture would be more prevalent among progressives because progressives themselves believe that the patron is likely to harbor offensive intentions. In other words, the *progressives'* perception that the patron may harbor offensive intentions induce them to project that perception on the adversary and believe that the latter would also perceive the patron's signal as an offensive posture. In the case of the controversy over the deployment of the Pershing missiles, the Germans liberals were also concerned that the Soviets would

perceive the deployment of the Pershing missiles as an offensive posture and thereby be provoked into carrying out a preemptive strike "in order to neutralize the threats of a first strike from the Pershing missiles" (Quint, 2007, 18).

We argue that this divergence between conservatives and progressives are likely to be observable only with respect to *opaque* reassurance signals since they enable the possibility of misuse by the patron. We have no reason to expect that such differences would be observed with respect to reassurance signals that are transparent and cannot be misused by the patron. For example, scholars have widely shown that U.S. presidents undertake official visits and issue statements of support to bolster extended deterrence (McManus, 2018). These signals do not lack transparency in terms of their intentions. The leader of the patron − i.e. the U.S. president − sends a hand-tying signal, making it clear in the statement that Washington seeks to bolster deterrence. Since such signals would not contain elements that could be misused by the patron to initiate conflicts, there is no reason to expect that there would be a divergence between progressives and conservatives.

At this point, it might be helpful to contrast our argument with the concept of *motivated skepticism* proposed in past research (Taber and Lodge, 2006; Nyhan and Reifler, 2010; Kertzer, Rathbun and Rathbun, 2020). According to Nyhan and Reifler (2010, 307), "people tend to display bias in evaluating political arguments and evidence, favoring those that reinforce their existing views and disparaging those that contradict their views." In a survey experiment in which individuals are asked to interpret costly signals from Iran regarding its nuclear program, Kertzer, Rathbun and Rathbun (2020) show that individuals high in militant internationalism are less receptive of reassurance signals while those high in cooperative internationalism are more receptive. We instead argue that the qualitative property of the

signal determines whether the receiver is likely to be reassured by the sender's signal.

Various historical accounts and survey data offer credence to our theory that progressives are less likely to be reassured by the patron's reassurance signals involving military assets compared to their conservative counterparts. For example, Prime Minister Gerhardsen of Norway refused to deploy U.S. nuclear weapons, most likely due to a strong opposition from the left (Forland, 1997). In the case of West Germany in the early 1980s, the Social Democratic Party (SPD) and the Greens were vehemently opposed to the deployment of the Pershing II missiles out of fears of entrapment. As Frau Kelly of the Green party once remarked during the debate on the deployment preceding the vote, "we are not ready to sacrifice Hamburg for Chicago."[7] Willy Brandt was also concerned that it would raise the risks of a nuclear war (Brandt, 1984). This opposition from the left to the deployment could not be attributed to partisan politics alone.[8] A recent survey also shows that progressive political elites and citizens in Germany have been more skeptical of the utility of stationing nuclear weapons on German soil (Onderco and Smetana, 2021). Similar observations can be made for alliances outside Europe as well. For example, Catalinac (2010) shows that Wellington's elites had concerns of entrapment in an unwanted war due to U.S. unilateralism. Similar entrapment concerns were the basis of the criticism from the left with respect to the U.S. missile tests in Australia in the 1980s (Mack, 1988).

Some readers might argue that the above accounts are mere relics of the Cold War and dismiss the relevance of the question. We argue that such dynamics are likely to hold

[7] *Deutscher Bundestag Stenographischer Bericht 36. Sitzung Bonn, Dienstag, den 22. November 1983*

[8] A logistic regression analysis of the roll-call voting behavior during the 10th Bundestag shows that the partisan divide was more severe for the Pershing issue compared to other issues sponsored by the conservative parties, meaning that progressive parties (SPD/Green) opposed the Pershing issue more than other issues. The results are presented in OA1.

in many asymmetric alliances even in the present day. In the context of South Korean politics, Shim (2019) argues that "left/right favours a more dovish/hawkish approach to North Korea." According to Chae and Kim (2008), progressives have been more likely to believe that the United States does not consider South Korean interests in dealing with North Korea. Similarly, Moller (2022), argues that the progressive political elites in South Korea have possessed greater fears of entrapment. Numerous other works on South Korean politics echo the same theme of the divide between the progressives and the conservatives with respect to the attitude on the use of force against North Korea (e.g., Hix and Jun, 2009; Bae, 2020).

In sum, our discussion shows that ideology could be an important factor for both the mass public and the political elites in how they perceive reassurance signals from the patron. While conservatives are likely to be receptive of the patron's reassurance signals even if they are *opaque*, progressive are likely to be less receptive due to their dovishness and the low level of trust regarding the purpose behind the patron's signals. The extant discussion leads to the following hypothesis:

H1: *Progressives are less likely to be reassured by the patron's opaque reassurance signals compared to conservatives.*

Research Design

Case Selection

We employ a mixed-method approach by conducting text analysis and reanalyzing two prior survey experiments to test our theory. A survey experiment would help to alleviate concerns of internal validity, but it is unclear that the findings from a group of survey respondents could render any important insights about what political elites think about costly signals from the patron. Likewise, while conducting a text analysis may add confidence to the external validity of our theory, it presents additional challenges since text data are often noisy. Combining these methods helps to overcome the weaknesses of the respective approaches by examining both the responses of the mass public and the elite as well as maximizing both external and internal validity.

We also recognize that the ideal way to test our hypotheses would be to conduct randomized controlled trials in which we randomly assign reassurance signals on a representative sample of interest and measure whether they have been reassured. Such approaches have been increasing adopted in other contexts with the rise of elite survey experiments (Yarhi-Milo, Kertzer and Renshon, 2018; Chu and Recchia, 2022; Renshon, Yarhi-Milo and Kertzer, 2023). We deemed such an approach practically infeasible for our purpose because of the difficulty in acquiring an elite sample. As an alternative, we deduce observable implications from our theory and test them in our respective studies. Although these tests are indirect, we suggest that they are theoretically-grounded and appropriate for our purpose.

We test our theory on the South Korean case. South Korea represents a good case to

study because it is a key ally of the United States in East Asia with a robust democratic system that allows various political factions to express independent views. The issue we examine is the deployment of the Terminal High Altitude Area Defense (THAAD) missiles to South Korea. In February 2016, the United States and South Korea announced the deployment of the THAAD system in South Korea. South Korea's conservative Park Geun-hye administration explained that the purpose of the deployment was to enhance South Korea's security and protect United States Forces Korea (USFK) from the potential nuclear missile threats posed by North Korea. However, some were more doubtful of its utility and outright expressed concerns that the United States was exploiting South Korea's position for its own benefits even though the THAAD is basically a missile defense system.

Study 1: Media Analysis

Research Design

For the first study, we conducted a text analysis of the major media outlets – *Chosun Ilbo* (조선일보), *Dong-A Ilbo* (동아일보), *Hankyeoreh* (한겨레) and *Kyunghyang Shinmun* (경향신문). In analyzing the text from the major media outlets, we employed structural topic modeling (STM) to let the algorithm to discover the various topics discussed by the media. We tried different specifications regarding the number of splines used to control for the potential heterogeneity in the distribution of topics covered over time. We also accounted for presidents' political orientation by controlling whether a president is progressive or not in the regression models to assess whether government's ideology affects the distribution of topics. We used the `stm` package for conducting the main analysis (Roberts, Stewart and

Tingley, 2019).

We first downloaded the newspaper articles from *Bigkinds*[9] and pre-processed the data by stemming and dropping stopwords. The main independent variable of interest is the ideological inclination of the four main media outlets, *Chosun Ilbo*, *Dong-A Ilbo*, *Hankyoreh* and *Kyunhyang Shinmun*. The first two of these four outlets are conservative outlets while the latter two are progressive. The keyword we used for searching the newspapers articles was 사드 (*THAAD*). We downloaded the articles of the four South Korean news media mentioning 사드 over a period of eight years, from June 2014, when THAAD was first mentioned in the Korean National Assembly, to June 2023, when the deployment was officially completed after the environmental impact assessment was conducted. We were able to find 12,405 articles covering the THAAD deployment issue during the specific period.

Since STM is essentially a clustering technique and researchers can arbitrarily determine the number of topics around which keywords would form clusters, it is not guaranteed that each topic contains the expected contents because STM just summarizes and clusters a large collection of documents by their contents based on the number of topic researchers set. In implementing our models, we set the number of topics based on multiple diagnostic tests.

In terms of the empirical findings, we expect to see progressive media outlets expressing a greater level of opposition to the deployment of the THAAD missiles. Moreover, given our theoretical mechanism, such opposition should stem from concerns about the increased risk of entrapment as a result of the deployment.

Table 1: Keywords with Topics (THAAD, 9 topics)

	Topic	Keywords
1	Security	미사일 (missile), 북한 (North Korea), 발사 (launch), 요격 (interception), 방어 (defense), 미국 (USA), 사드 (THAAD)
2	Sino-Korean Relations	중국 (China), 대통령 (president), 외교 (diplomacy), 한국 (South Korea), 사드 (THAAD), 양국 (the two countries), 회담 (meeting)
3	Anti-THAAD	사드 (THAAD), 배치 (deployment), 국방부 (Ministry of National Defense), 정부 (government), 결정 (decision), 성주 (Seongju (city)), 반대 (opposition)
4	Geopolitics	중국 (China), 미국 (USA), 한국 (South Korea), 일본 (Japan), 경제 (economy), 외교 (diplomacy), 국가 (State)
5	Domestic Politics	후보 (candidate), 대통령 (president), 대표 ((party) leader), 국민 (people), 대선 (presidential election), 의원 (lawmaker), 문재인 (Moon Jae-in)
6	Economic Impact of THAAD	중국 (China), 한국 (South Korea), 기업 (Company), 사드 (THAAD), 보복 (retaliation), 시장 (Market), 정부 (government)
7	Anti-Park Geun-hye	대통령 (president), 박근혜 (Park Geun-hye), 정부 (government), 집회 (protest), 국민 (people), 탄핵 (impeachment), 청와대 (Cheongwadae)
8	Inter-Korean Relations	북한 (North Korea), 정부 (government), 한반도 (Korean Penninsula), 미국 (USA), 대북 (in/on/for North Korea), 대통령 (president), 안보 (security)
9	US Foreign Policy	미국 (USA), 트럼프 (Trump), 대통령 (president), 한국 (South Korea), 행정부 (administration), 미군 (US forces), 워싱턴 (Washington)

Empirical Findings

We first present the results from the quantitative text analysis conducted on the major media outlets.[10] Table 1 presents the top seven keywords for the nine topics along with their labels.[11] Each topic contains keywords that are clearly distinct from those of other topics. For example, since the keywords in the third and seventh topics reflect opposition to the deployment itself and negative views on President Park, who approved the THAAD deployment, these topics can be easily labeled as *Anti-THAAD* and *Anti-Park Geun-hye*, respectively. Moreover, articles leverage each topic clearly show patterns for these labels. articles that weight *Anti-THAAD* topic primarily suggest Articles that comprise the Anti-THAAD topic primarily criticize procedural issues related to the deployment of the THAAD

[9] https://www.bigkinds.or.kr/.

[10] We designated the number of topics to be clustered as nine topics based on the diagnostic tests. See OA7.

[11] The distribution of the keyword probability is in the appendix. See OA5.

system, such as "Controversy Over THAAD Environmental Assessment Triggered by Ministry of Defense's 'Premature Decision'" or "Ministry of Defense Used 'Land Splitting' Trick to Avoid THAAD Environmental Assessment." Articles about Anti-Park Geun-hye topics, on the other hand, mainly report candlelight rallies in South Korea in 2016 requesting for the president Park's impeachment which criticize her faults in presidential office including the THAAD deployment.

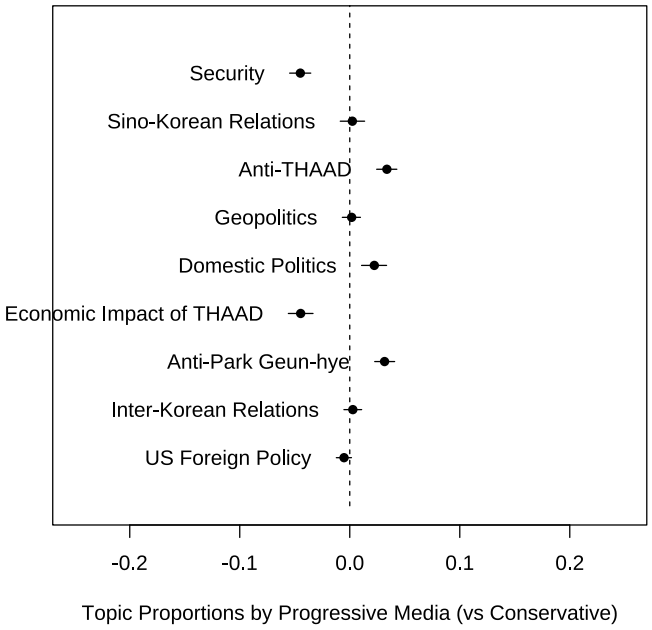
On the contrary, the first and fourth topics contain words related to North Korea's military ambitions and countries as well issues in North East Asia. Therefore, we label them as *Security* and *Geopolitics*, respectively. Articles associated with the topic of *Security* primarily report on North Korea's missile tests and its impact on the region,[12] while those related to the topic of *Geopolitics* cover great power competition and its implications for regional security.[13]

Figure 2 presents the treatment effect of media bias on the distribution of topics per document. The results clearly show that progressive media cover the THAAD deployment issue more negatively than conservative media. Progressive outlets discuss *Anti-THAAD*, a topic related to protests against the THAAD deployment, and *Anti-Park Geun-hye*, a topic related to protests against the president who decided the deployment, significantly more than conservative media. In contrast, conservative media focus more on *Security*, a topic related to North Korea's military ambitions, and *Economic Impact of THAAD*, a topic addressing economic impact of the THAAD deployment mainly from China's economic retaliation against

[12]"North Korea's New Missile Can Strike Targets Within 4 Minutes – Impossible to Defend Against When Mixed with Multiple Rocket Launchers"; "Kim Jong-un Confirms Nuclear Submarine Design Complete, Capable of Surprise Attack on U.S."

[13]"THAAD should be understood historically as a new chapter in the struggle between land and sea powers. Korea finds itself at the crossroads of this conflict." See OA9 for the first few sentences of articles constituting each topic. Translations are omitted due to space constraints.

Figure 2: Treatment Effect Associated with Topics (THAAD)



the THAAD deployment, more than progressive media. These findings suggest that progressive media highlight domestic anti-THAAD movements, while conservative media emphasize the legitimacy of THAAD by covering North Korea's military threats and attributing blame to China for its economic retaliation.

As expected, we could observe concerns about the risk of entrapment. For example, an article that feature in Hankyoreh that South Korea had to face a heightened level of "geopolitical risk" as a result of the deployment (Park, 2019). Relatedly, we could also see evidence of concerns about the lack of sovereignty in the decision-making process. For example, an article titled published in *Kyunghyang Shinmun* claimed that the argument that South Korea could maintain autonomy over the operation of the THAAD missiles that are funded by Washington is faulty (Yoo, 2016).

However, we expect progressives and conservatives to show different attitudes toward the

patron's reassurance signal only when it is *opaque*. We collected articles from four South Korean media outlets covering the Washington–Seoul summits during the same period as the THAAD issue and reran the STM. The results show that for *transparent* reassurance signals, the divergence between conservative and progressive coverage does not appear. We find no evidence that progressive media covered the summits more negatively than conservative media. Most topics, including security-related topics, are reported similarly by both progressive and conservative outlets. These results reaffirm that progressives and conservatives exhibit similar attitudes toward the patron's *transparent* reassurance signals.[14]

Study 2: Reanalysis of Suh (2025) and Ko (2019)

Research Design

Past studies on nuclear proliferation highlight how the absence of reassurance signals from the patron encourage the protégés to pursue independent nuclear arsenals (Bleek and Lorber, 2014; Debs and Monteiro, 2017). There is little to no discussion on whether and how political ideology interacts with reassurance signals in influencing the protégé's attitudes towards nuclear proliferation. Based on our theory, we expect that costly reassurance signals can sometimes elicit fears of entrapment among progressives and thereby strengthen their willingness to pursue nuclear weapons.

To test our theory, we reanalyze two experimental studies examining how the patron's reassurance signals influence South Korean citizens' attitudes toward acquiring independent nuclear arsenals. While political ideology does not play a significant role in the theoriza-

[14]See OA2.

tion of either of these two studies, we expect that there would be a significant interaction effect between ideology and the patron's *opaque* reassurance signals. We first reanalyze Suh (2025)'s experimental study on the effectiveness of various reassurance signals the United States could employ during times of crisis. The experiment consists of five conditions – *Control*, *Conventional Signal*, *Nuclear Signal*, *Diplomatic Overture*, and *Statement of Support*.[15] The dependent variable in this study measured the degree of reassurance by asking "If South Korea were to face this situation tomorrow, how safe would South Korea be from a potential North Korean military aggression?" (Suh, 2025, 15). Political ideology was measured on a 5-point scale with 1 being strongly conservative and 5 being strongly progressive.

We next reanalyze Ko (2019)'s experimental study on the effectiveness of various measures that the United States could take to discourage the protégé from pursuing independent nuclear weapons. The study randomly assigns various treatment conditions to a representative sample of the South Korean adult population to examine the average treatment effect on the likelihood of their support for independent nuclear arsenals, measured on a binary scale. Ko (2019) has four conditions – *Control*, *Declaration*, *Deployment*, and *Threat* – in

[15]The treatments in this study consisted of short texts coupled with visual aids to best reflect how the respondents would receive the information through media outlets in real life. The text portions of the treatments are given as follows: "After North Korea's military mobilization, the United States government announces that **an aircraft carrier strike group** is operating in waters off the Korean Peninsula and conducting a series of joint military exercises with South Korean military forces, and **the strike group** would stay until North Korea's provocation ends." (*Conventional Signal*); "After North Korea's military mobilization, the United States government announces that **two B-2 strategic nuclear bombers** are deployed to South Korea and are conducting a series of joint military exercises with South Korean military forces, and **the bombers** would stay until North Korea's provocation ends." (*Nuclear Signal*); "After North Korea's military mobilization, the United States government announces that **the United States does not desire conflict,** and it is **willing to begin earnest negotiations** with North Korea to discuss denuclearization and arms control issues if North Korea stop provocative military behavior." (*Diplomatic Overture*); "After North Korea's military mobilization, the United States government announces that "**U.S. support for South Korea's defense is unequivocal,** and it will **coordinate closely with South Korea government** to **ensure readiness and deter further provocation.**" (*Statement of Support*)

her study.[16] Ko (2019) measures ideology on a 5-point scale.[17] We interact the treatment conditions with ideology and focus on the interaction ideology and the *Deployment* treatment since this treatment is analogous to the *Nuclear Signal* treatment in Suh (2025).

We expect that progressives will be less reassured than conservatives by the deployment of the bombers in Suh (2025) and more likely to express support for the acquisition of independent nuclear weapons when treated with reassurance signals because of their fear of entrapment in Ko (2019). Similar to the concerns that the West German liberals held over the deployment of the Pershing II missiles, South Korean progressives would be more likely to have greater fears of entrapment once exposed to the information that could suggest that Washington would be employing an instrument that would enable unilateral escalation.

Empirical Findings

Table 2 presents the results for the reanalysis of the two experimental studies. The top panel of Table 2 presents the results for the reanalysis of Suh (2025). As expected, the interaction term between *Ideology* and *Nuclear Signal* is negative and statistically significant, suggesting that progressives are less likely to be reassured by the patron's opaque reassurance signals compared to conservatives. Note however, that the interaction term between *Ideology* and *Diplomatic Overture* is not statistically significant, suggesting that ideology does not play a significant role in moderating reassurance for transparent signals.

[16] Ko (2019) gives the treatments as follows: "a superpower ally publicly promised the country a nuclear umbrella." (*Declare*); "a superpower ally deployed strategic nuclear weapons on the soil of the country, publicly promising a nuclear umbrella" (*Deploy*); "a superpower ally, which publicly promised a nuclear umbrella, is opposed to any attempt at seeking nuclear armament, telling the country (that the respondents belong to) that it will withdraw from the alliance if the country develops indigenous nuclear weapons" (*Threat*); "the country does not have a super power ally that can offer a nuclear umbrella" (*Control*).

[17] Ko (2019) codes ideology on a 5-point scale with 1 being very liberal and 5 being very conservative. We recode this with 1 being the most conservative and 5 being the most progressive to be consistent with Suh (2025).

Table 2: Reanalysis of Suh (2025) and Ko (2019)

Panel A: Suh (2025)	*Dependent variable:*			
	Perceived Safety from N. Korean Aggression			
	OLS		*logistic*	
	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3	Model 4
Conventional Signal	0.042***	0.107^{+}	0.380**	1.642*
	(0.012)	(0.054)	(0.138)	(0.682)
Nuclear Signal	0.036**	0.158**	0.372**	1.658*
	(0.012)	(0.056)	(0.137)	(0.670)
Diplomatic Overture	−0.001	0.038	−0.015	0.637
	(0.012)	(0.056)	(0.146)	(0.739)
Statement of Support	0.040**	0.123*	0.406**	1.315^{+}
	(0.012)	(0.055)	(0.138)	(0.691)
Ideology	0.023***	0.044***	0.241***	0.521**
	(0.006)	(0.012)	(0.061)	(0.168)
Conventional Signal x Ideology		−0.022		−0.404^{+}
		(0.017)		(0.211)
Nuclear Signal x Ideology		−0.040*		−0.413*
		(0.018)		(0.207)
Diplomatic Overture x Ideology		−0.013		−0.207
		(0.018)		(0.226)
Statement of Support x Ideology		−0.027		−0.288
		(0.018)		(0.210)
Constant	0.248***	0.188***	−3.219***	−4.076***
	(0.039)	(0.050)	(0.430)	(0.648)
Control Variables	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	3,390	3,390	3,390	3,390
Adjusted R^2	0.027	0.028		
Log Likelihood			−1,683.462	−1,680.181

Panel B: Ko (2019)	*Dependent variable:*			
	Support for Nuclear Armament (Binary)			
	LPM		*logistic*	
	Model 5	Model 6	Model 7	Model 8
Declaration	−0.030	−0.078	−0.125	−0.321
	(0.057)	(0.098)	(0.236)	(0.404)
Deployment	−0.051	−0.252*	−0.214	−1.052*
	(0.058)	(0.102)	(0.241)	(0.436)
Threat	−0.016	−0.100	−0.065	−0.411
	(0.058)	(0.099)	(0.237)	(0.407)
Ideology	−0.014	−0.048*	−0.059	−0.198*
	(0.012)	(0.023)	(0.048)	(0.098)
Declaration x Ideology		0.019		0.079
		(0.033)		(0.138)
Deployment x Ideology		0.077*		0.323*
		(0.032)		(0.136)
Threat x Ideology		0.034		0.142
		(0.033)		(0.137)
Constant	0.386**	0.484***	−0.468	−0.073
	(0.132)	(0.143)	(0.546)	(0.593)
Control Variables	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	600	600	600	600
Adjusted R^2	0.013	0.018		
Log Likelihood			−405.507	−402.305

Note: Robust standard errors in parentheses. Full models with demographic control variables are in appendix. $^{+}$p<0.1; *p<0.05; **p<0.01; ***p<0.001

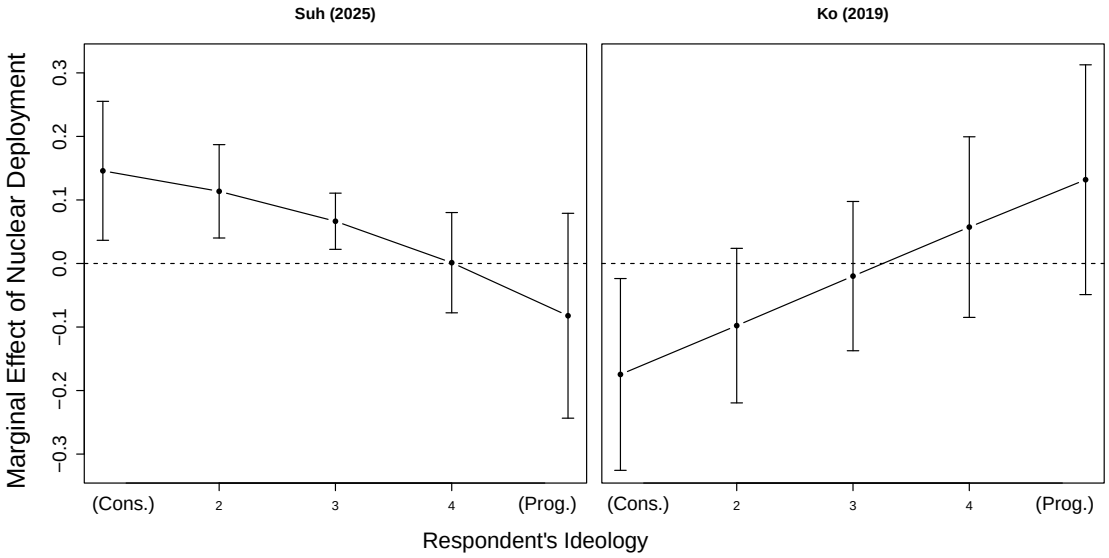
These null results are worth emphasizing because McManus (2018) shows that US presidential visits are more effective than nuclear deployment in deterring the initiation of militarized conflicts. In this sense, US presidential visits represent a stronger signal that influences the regional dynamics. If anti-Americanism were the driving mechanism behind our main results, we should be able to observe a similar backlash from the progressives since they supposedly oppose everything about the United States in general. Yet, this is not what we observe with respect to the transparent reassurance signals.

The bottom panel of Table 2 presents the results for the reanalysis of Ko (2019). It shows that there is a positive and statistically significant interaction effect between *Deployment* and *Ideology*, suggesting that progressives (conservatives) are more (less) likely to support independent nuclear armament when exposed to the treatment condition that the patron would deploy nuclear weapons to the protégé state. Moreover, *Ideology* alone shows a negative and significant association with support for nuclear armament, suggesting that without a reassurance signal, respondents are less inclined to favor independent nuclear weapons as being more progressive.

It is also worth noting that the interaction term between declaration and ideology is not statistically significant. If anti-Americanism were the main driving mechanism behind our results, we would expect that progressive individuals would feel insecure from all types of signals of support sent by the patron. However, the absence of the statistically significant effect serves as a form of placebo test in which we do not observe a statistically significant effect

Figure 3 shows the marginal effects of the treatment conditioned on the ideological inclination of the survey respondents based on model 4 (Ko, 2019). The graph shows that the

Figure 3: Marginal Effect of Reassurance on the Support for Independent Nuclear Armament



Note: The marginal effect is computed based on models 4 and 8 of Table 2.

effect of credible nuclear reassurance signals from Washington − 'deployment' for Ko (2019) − on the support for Seoul's acquisition of nuclear weapons increases as the respondent's ideology becomes more liberal. The reanalysis of the experiment demonstrates that progressives are more likely to express greater support for the acquisition of nuclear arsenals when exposed to costly reassurance signals. The finding supports our theory that more progressive respondents are less likely to be reassured by the patron's reassurance signals due to their fear of entrapment and thereby be more likely to support South Korea's independent nuclear armament. In alignment with our theoretical discussion on the relationship between hawkishness and armament buildup, it is perhaps worth emphasizing again that it is not contradictory to observe progressive individuals showing a greater level of support for the acquisition of independent nuclear weapons under the *Deployment* condition.

Analogous reasoning follows in the case of nuclear weapons as well. Scholars might commonly assume that more hawkish individuals would support the acquisition of nuclear

arsenals while dovish individuals would oppose such measures. However, such assumptions do not hold given our understanding of the literature on nuclear weapons. Nuclear weapons are the ultimate weapon of deterrence. Dovish individuals may believe that acquiring nuclear weapons are useful precisely because they deter military aggression and they do not have to resort to the use of force. In other words, support for independent nuclear weapons acquisition does not translate to support for nuclear weapons use.

Study 3: Elite Speeches

Research Design

Some readers might argue that neither the analysis of major media outlets nor the reanalysis of previous experimental studies matter since they are not indicative of foreign policy preferences at the elite level. Indeed, the extent to which the mass public influences foreign policy has been an ongoing debate among IR scholars (e.g., Kertzer and Zeitzoff, 2017) and we are fully aware of the limitations in drawing implications from analyzing the policy preferences of the mass public at large. Given the concern that the mass public has little to no effect on foreign policy, we further conduct a analysis of the speeches of the legislative members of the "Foreign Policy and Defense Committee" in South Korea's National Assembly from 2014 to 2023 and classified their statements regarding the deployment of THAAD missiles into three categories: *positive*, *neutral* and *negative*.[18] We classified the National Assembly members into two groups, progressive and conservative depending on their party affiliation.[19]

[18]These speech acts by South Korean legislative members can be downloaded from the National Assembly BigData website (https://dataset.nanet.go.kr/). We used the keyword 사드 (THAAD) to search for the relevant speech acts.

[19]During the period of the THAAD deployment,the New Frontier Party (새누리당) was a conservative and incumbent party, and the Democratic Party of Korea (더불어민주당) was a progressive party.

Because of the small sample size, we decided to hand-code the legislators' responses depending on the stance on the deployment of the THAAD missiles conveyed by the speech act. An example of a speech act that was classified as *negative*, or being opposed to the deployment, is a statement from Kang Chang-il: "THAAD is for the US national interest rather than that of South Korea." An example of a speech act that was classified as *positive*, or being supportive of the deployment, is a statement from Won Yoo-chul: "it is necessary for the South Korean government to conduct a better PR effort that THAAD is being deployed in response to North Korean nuclear and missile threats..."

Most of these speech acts were classified as *neutral* as we found that a significant proportion of these speech acts either contained insufficient information or were not relevant to the issue for us to categorize the speech as expressing support or opposition to the deployment of the THAAD missiles. For example, some speech acts included the word THAAD merely because the legislator in question was naming a host of diplomatic issues that South Korea was facing.[20] At the same time, many of these speech acts were generated when the legislators were questioning the foreign minister about the issue.[21] As these speech acts were more of a question asking for the opinion of the foreign minister rather than a statement expressing their own opinions on the issue, these speech acts were classified as being *neutral*.

Given the importance and the salience of the issue, however, it is not surprising that the issue was discussed widely among the political elites in South Korea. There were diverse reactions from the elites within South Korea surrounding the THAAD issue. While there

[20]For example, at the 332nd meeting of the Foreign Affairs and Unification Committee held on May 4, 2015, Rep. Kim Hyun asked the Minister of Foreign Affairs about the impact of joining AIIB and deploying THAAD on diplomatic relations between South Korea and neighboring countries.

[21]For example, at the confirmation hearing for the Minister of Unification held on March 11, 2015, Rep. Lee Jae-oh asked the nominee for the Minister of Unification whether he supported or opposed the deployment of THAAD.

were understandably negative reactions towards China from a significant proportion of the domestic constituents to China's imposition of economic sanctions when South Korea ultimately pushed ahead with the deployment, others also expressed concerns that South Korea was becoming entrapped in a great power competition between Washington and Beijing. As one may expect, the THAAD dispute was an important foreign policy issue in South Korea.

In terms of the empirical findings, we expect to observe more legislators from the progressive parties expressing negative sentiments to the deployment of the THAAD missiles. Moreover, if our proposed mechanism is valid, we should be able to observe such sentiments stemming from concerns of entrapment and the loss of autonomy due to the deployment. To test our expectation, we conducted a series of logistic regression analysis. Our unit of analysis is legislator-session: if a certain legislator in a given session made at least one statement expressing opposition to the deployment of the missiles, we coded the legislator as being opposed to the deployment of the missiles for the given session.[22] For the control variables, we include the tenure and the gender of the legislator, the executive of the government as well as the ruling party during which the session was held.[23]

Empirical Findings

There were approximately 560 speech acts by 59 legislative members across multiple parties in South Korea during the period examined. While the deployment of the THAAD missiles was an important issue, not all sessions of the committee meetings covered the issue. We examined how various political elites with potentially heterogeneous policy preferences reacted

[22]While theoretically possible, we observed no legislator with speech acts expressing both support for and opposition to the deployment across different speech acts.

[23]We replicate the findings at the legislator-level and find that results are consistent with findings using speech-level data. See OA4.

to the deployment of THAAD missiles.

We present our regression analysis of the legislator responses to the THAAD deployment in Table 3. Model 1 (2) uses a binary dependent variable with *negative* response (*positive* response) coded as 1 and the other two categories coded as 0. Model 3 uses a ordered logistic regression where *negative*, *neutral*, and *positive* responses are coded as -1, 0, and 1, respectively. All the models show support for our theory: members of progressive parties, on average, spoke more negatively about the THAAD deployment than those of conservative parties at the Foreign Affairs and Unification Committee meeting.[24]

What justifications do the progressive legislators provide in expressing such negative sentiments about the deployment? We have argued that progressive legislators are likely to be more concerned about the possibility of entrapment due to the deployment. We were able to observe concerns about the possibility of entrapment due to THAAD missiles upsetting the balance of power and hint that the United States might have revisionist intentions. We find some evidence to support these claims. For example, Kyung-hyup Kim stated that he regarded "the decision to deploy THAAD as a move to undermine balanced diplomacy in Northeast Asia and usher in a system of new Cold War." Hoon Sul also argued that the THAAD deployment essentially represented Seoul's accession to the missile defense system and signified a serious violation of Seoul's sovereignty.[25]

Admittedly, the apparent opposition from the progressive members should be interpreted with caution as the committee members had no authority to formally block the THAAD de-

[24]We used Firth penalized logistic regression for Model 2 due to separation issues (Firth, 1993; Zorn, 2005). Since there is no canned procedure for calculating clustered standard errors in the case of Firth penalized logistic regression, we adapted the conventional procedure with slight modifications. The type of standard error used makes no difference in substantive interpretation.

[25]*March 15th, 2017, Foreign Affairs and Unification Committee*

Table 3: Legislator Response to THAAD Deployment

	Dependent variable:		
	Negative	Positive	Neg.-Pos.
	logistic	*Firth penalized logistic*	*ordered logistic*
	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3
Progressive Party	2.890*	−3.085***	−3.317***
	(1.160)	(0.447)	(0.988)
Tenure	0.386	−0.009	−0.157
	(0.284)	(0.201)	(0.188)
Male	0.046	0.040	0.137
	(1.321)	(0.560)	(0.944)
Ruling Party	1.218	0.264	0.400
	(0.849)	(0.412)	(0.595)
Observations	261	261	261
Meeting FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Log Likelihood	-43.979	-27.491	-110.696
Negative|Neutral			-7.516
Neutral|Positive			-0.416

Note: Legislator-session is the unit of analysis. Robust standard errors clustered by legislator in parentheses. $^{+}$p<0.1; *p<0.05; **p<0.01; ***p<0.001

ployment and ultimately seem to have conceded to the deployment without much protest. This apparent lack of protest does, however, raise an interesting question of why the progressive members expressed such negative sentiments. Given that there is a large body of literature suggesting that citizens do not like policy inconsistency (e.g., Tomz, 2007), it may be a little surprising that the progressive committee members seem to have ultimately acquiesced to the deployment despite the rhetoric. One potential explanation is the hypothesis suggested by Fearon (1994) in his original argument: leaders of small powers may wish to put on a veneer of initially standing firm even at the risk of ultimately backing down. As Fearon (1994, 580) notes: "leaders of small states may be rewarded for escalating crises with

big states and then backing down, where they would be castigated for simply backing down. Standing up to a "bully" may be praised even if one ultimately retreats." Of course, the irony here is that South Korea was not in a crisis bargaining situation with the United States – the conventional interpretation according to the rationalist framework would be that the United States was merely seeking to reassure South Korea by deploying THAAD missiles. Given such conventional wisdom, it is interesting to note that at least some segment of the population including political elites apparently believed that Washington was bullying Seoul into acquiescing to the deployment.

In the appendix, we once again demonstrate that the divergence between conservatives and progressives in South Korea do not appear with respect to *transparent* reassurance signals, showing that progressives do not oppose summits between Washington and Seoul. We find no evidence of progressives believing that such summits can lead to entrapment.

Conclusion and Discussion

Although past research suggests that states could build trust and communicate intentions through costly signals, we show that costly signals are effective only to the extent that states have a baseline level of trust. In particular, we show that progressive constituents within the protégé are less likely to be reassured through costly signals sent by the patron because it is not self-evident what the exact purpose of this costly signal is. On the contrary, costly signals can actually backfire because they may be perceived as a measure for the patron's divestment of the protégé's security autonomy which eventually entraps the protégé.

The contribution of our paper is threefold. First, it proposes a novel theory and provides systematic evidence on the heterogeneity of preferences within the protégé regarding the pro-

tégé's relationship with the patron. While past qualitative accounts have certainly discussed the divergence in preferences between conservatives and progressives (e.g., Moller, 2022), our study is the first to theorize the conditions under which the divergence in preferences is likely to become salient and test it using both quantitative and qualitative evidence.

Second, our study provides important implications for reassurance dynamics in asymmetric alliances. In contrast to the past literature that often assumes trust could be built through costly signals (e.g., Kydd, 2000), our study shows that reassurance is more difficult than previously thought. By showing how political ideology could be an important factor in determining whether the protégé would indeed be reassured, our work proposes an important element for examining reassurance dynamics in asymmetric alliances and contributes to the understanding of which segments of the protégé's populations are likely to have difficulty in being reassured by the patron.

Third, our study shows why some constituents within a protégé may have a greater fear of entrapment with respect to certain signals from the patron. To be clear, we are not the first to suggest that protégés can also fear entrapment. Indeed, past research also shows that protégés can indeed fear entrapment and this could be an important driver behind support for nuclear proliferation (e.g., Moller, 2022; Sukin, 2020). The contribution of our paper is to provide a theory to analyze these systemic differences between conservatives and progressives with respect to certain types of reassurance signals from the patron. In this paper, we sought to propose a theoretical framework through which we can conceptualize the varying degrees of fear of entrapment within the protégé depending on their political ideology.

While our research does not focus on polarization as the dependent variable, the study nonetheless has implications for the literature on the relationship between foreign policy

on polarization (e.g., Myrick, 2021). Intuitively, the patron would send reassurance signals when it believes that the protégé would be receptive of the measure at the state level. As such, we would expect to be able to observe strong partisan disagreements within a protégé when there is roughly an even divide between between progressives and conservatives with the latter being weakly dominant. The Pershing II missile and the THAAD deployment debates described in this paper pertain to this case.

One obvious limitation to the paper is the lack of generalizability as this study focuses on a single country as an in-depth case study. While we have provided a general theory on how political ideology might be an important factor in shaping the attitudes towards reassurance signals from the patron and have tested our theory on the case of South Korea, it remains to be investigated whether we would be able to observe such salient differences between conservatives and progressives in other protégés. Scholars studying asymmetric alliances with regional expertise of other countries might wish to examine whether such salient differences in preferences become apparent when similar incidents arise. For example, given the extensive research suggesting that Japanese foreign policy preferences with respect to the alliance with Washington is divided along partisanship (e.g., Proksch, Slapin and Thies, 2011; Jou and Endo, 2017), scholars may further wish to investigate whether similar findings arise in the case of Japan.

Perhaps another important concern regarding the theory and the analysis presented here might be that the theoretical framework we employ portrays progressives as being biased by analyzing complex alliance relationships through a simplistic lens of costly signaling. To be clear, the purpose of this study is not to measure the degree of psychological bias of different media outlets or individuals. Nor are we categorically claiming that conservatives hold an

objectively truthful view of the world and progressives hold a biased view of the world. Our main purpose has been to theorize and show that political ideology could be an important factor in how the different constituencies within the protégé respond to the costly signals from the patron.

Although past historical accounts clearly show that certain factions within protégés have had entrapment concerns with respect to the patron's reassurance signals is undeniable, scholars have at large employed the theoretical framework in which the patron reassures its protégés through costly reassurance signals. We suggest that this discrepancy between the empirical accounts and the theoretical model employed may be due to the lack of theoretical development in why and how reassurance signals might fail to reassure certain factions within the protégé. In other words, scholars might have simply treated cases of entrapment concerns of progressives as anomalies. We suggest that this finding is not something to be glossed over but rather something to be theorized carefully. We hope that our research will encourage other researchers to engage with this question more seriously.

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Funding declaration

No funding was received for this research.

Competing interests declaration

There are no competing interests with respect to this research.

Online Appendix for

Do Reassurance Signals Reassure? Political Ideology and Sender-Receiver Gap in Asymmetric Alliances

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OA1 Bayesian Logit Analysis of the 10th Bundestag

Table A1: German Roll Call Analysis for the 10th Bundestag. Source: Sieberer et al. (2020)

	Dependent variable: Yea/Nay		
	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3
CDU/CSU-FDP	8.89^{***}	8.88^{***}	8.90^{***}
	(0.28)	(0.28)	(0.28)
Pershing	-3.15^{***}	-3.15^{***}	-3.15^{***}
	(0.90)	(0.90)	(0.90)
CDU/CSU-FDP × Pershing	2.94^{*}	2.93^{*}	2.94^{*}
	(1.44)	(1.44)	(1.44)
Gender		0.23^{+}	0.24^{+}
		(0.13)	(0.14)
Age		0.02^{***}	0.02^{***}
		(0.01)	(0.01)
Constant	-2.28^{***}	-3.33^{***}	-3.42^{***}
	(0.04)	(0.27)	(0.34)
State FE	No	No	Yes
Observations	16921	16921	16921

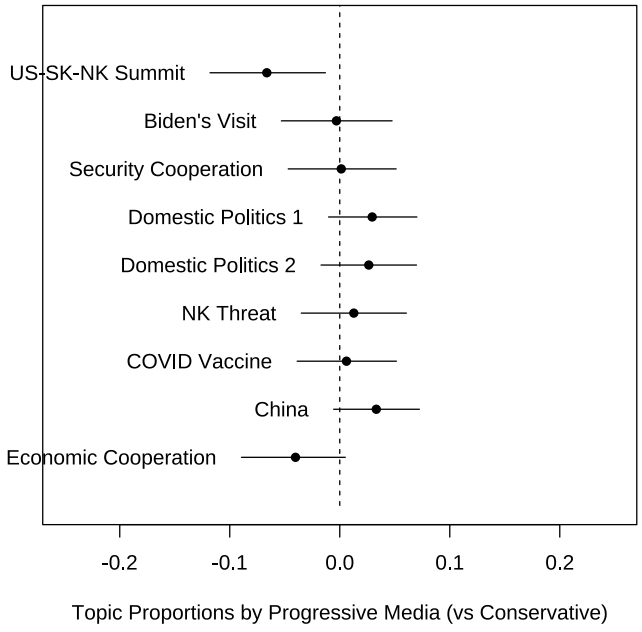
Note: The baseline category is SPD/Green. Only the motions with CDU/CSU and FDP as the two primary sponsors are included. $^{+}$p<0.1; *p<0.05; **p<0.01

OA2 Placebo Test (Study 1)

Table A2: Keywords with Topics (US-SK Summit, 9 topics)

	Topic	Keywords
1	US-SK-NK Summit	대통령 (president), 트럼프 (Trump), 회담 (summit), 정상 (leader), 북한 (North Korea), 미국 (USA), 한미 (US-SK)
2	Biden's Visit	대통령 (president), 바이든 (Biden), 정상 (leader), 미국 (USA), 회담 (summit), 한미 (US-SK), 방문 (summit)
3	Security Cooperation	한미 (US-SK), 북한 (North Korea), 미국 (USA), 협력 (cooperation), 대통령 (president), 정상 (leader), 한국 (South Korea)
4	Domestic Politics 1	대통령 (president), 후보 (candidate), 조사 (investigation), 국민 (people), 포인트 (point), 대표 ((party) leader), 지지율 (approval rate)
5	Domestic Politics 2	장관 (minister), 국민 (people), 정부 (government), 후보자 (candidate), 국회 (National Assembly), 대통령 (president), 임명 (appointment)
6	NK Threat	북한 (North Korea), 정부 (government), 대통령 (president), 미국 (USA), 문재인 (Moon Jae-in), 미사일 (missle), 발사 (launch)
7	COVID Vaccine	대통령 (president), 백신 (vaccine), 대표 ((party) leader), 의원 (lawmaker), 국민 (people), 한미 (USA-SK), 회담 (summit)
8	China	중국 (China), 미국 (USA), 한국 (South Korea), 정부 (government), 외교 (diplomacy), 일본 (Japan), 미사일 (missile)
9	Economic Cooperation	미국 (USA), 대통령 (president), 한국 (South Korea), 중국 (China), 한미(US-SK), 정부 (government), 반도체 (semiconductor)

Figure A1: Treatment Effect Associated with Topics (US-SK Summit)



OA3 Regression Results of Study 2 (Full Models)

Table A3: Reanalysis of Ko (2019)

	Dependent variable:			
	Support for Nuclear Armament			
	LPM		*logistic*	
	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3	Model 4
Declaration	−0.030	−0.078	−0.125	−0.321
	(0.057)	(0.098)	(0.236)	(0.404)
Deployment	−0.051	−0.252*	−0.214	−1.052*
	(0.058)	(0.102)	(0.241)	(0.436)
Threat	−0.016	−0.100	−0.065	−0.411
	(0.058)	(0.099)	(0.237)	(0.407)
Ideology	−0.014	−0.048*	−0.059	−0.198*
	(0.012)	(0.023)	(0.048)	(0.098)
Age	0.038*	0.035+	0.156*	0.147+
	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.075)	(0.076)
Education	0.015	0.014	0.062	0.058
	(0.036)	(0.036)	(0.148)	(0.150)
Gender	−0.109**	−0.116**	−0.447**	−0.481**
	(0.041)	(0.041)	(0.170)	(0.172)
Declaration x Ideology		0.019		0.079
		(0.033)		(0.138)
Deployment x Ideology		0.077*		0.323*
		(0.032)		(0.136)
Threat x Ideology		0.034		0.142
		(0.033)		(0.137)
Constant	0.386**	0.484***	−0.468	−0.073
	(0.132)	(0.143)	(0.546)	(0.593)
Control Variables	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	600	600	600	600
Adjusted R^2	0.013	0.018		
Log Likelihood			−405.507	−402.305
Akaike Inf. Crit.			827.014	826.609

Note: Robust standard errors in parentheses. +p<0.1; *p<0.05; . **p<0.01; ***p<0.001

Table A4: Reanalysis of Suh (2025)

	Dependent variable:			
	Perceived Safety from North Korean Military Aggression			
	OLS		*logistic*	
	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3	Model 4
Conventional Signal	0.042^{***}	0.107^{+}	0.380^{**}	1.642^{*}
	(0.012)	(0.054)	(0.138)	(0.682)
Nuclear Signal	0.036^{**}	0.158^{**}	0.372^{**}	1.658^{*}
	(0.012)	(0.056)	(0.137)	(0.670)
Diplomatic Overture	−0.001	0.038	−0.015	0.637
	(0.012)	(0.056)	(0.146)	(0.739)
Statement of Support	0.040^{**}	0.123^{*}	0.406^{**}	1.315^{+}
	(0.012)	(0.055)	(0.138)	(0.691)
Ideology	0.023^{***}	0.044^{***}	0.241^{***}	0.521^{**}
	(0.006)	(0.012)	(0.061)	(0.168)
Gender	-0.056^{***}	-0.055^{***}	-0.500^{***}	-0.494^{***}
	(0.008)	(0.008)	(0.090)	(0.090)
Age	0.0003	0.0003	−0.004	−0.004
	(0.0003)	(0.0003)	(0.003)	(0.003)
Foreign Policy Attention	−0.010	−0.013	0.169	0.143
	(0.028)	(0.028)	(0.301)	(0.301)
North Korea Attention	−0.005	−0.004	0.810^{**}	0.820^{**}
	(0.027)	(0.027)	(0.301)	(0.301)
Education	0.022^{**}	0.021^{**}	0.154^{+}	0.150^{+}
	(0.007)	(0.007)	(0.080)	(0.080)
Conventional Signal x Ideology		−0.022		-0.404^{+}
		(0.017)		(0.211)
Nuclear Signal x Ideology		-0.040^{*}		-0.413^{*}
		(0.018)		(0.207)
Diplomatic Overture x Ideology		−0.013		−0.207
		(0.018)		(0.226)
Statement of Support x Ideology		−0.027		−0.288
		(0.018)		(0.210)
Constant	0.248^{***}	0.188^{***}	-3.219^{***}	-4.076^{***}
	(0.039)	(0.050)	(0.430)	(0.648)
Observations	3,390	3,390	3,390	3,390
Adjusted R^2	0.027	0.028		
Log Likelihood			−1,683.462	−1,680.181
Akaike Inf. Crit.			3,388.923	3,390.363

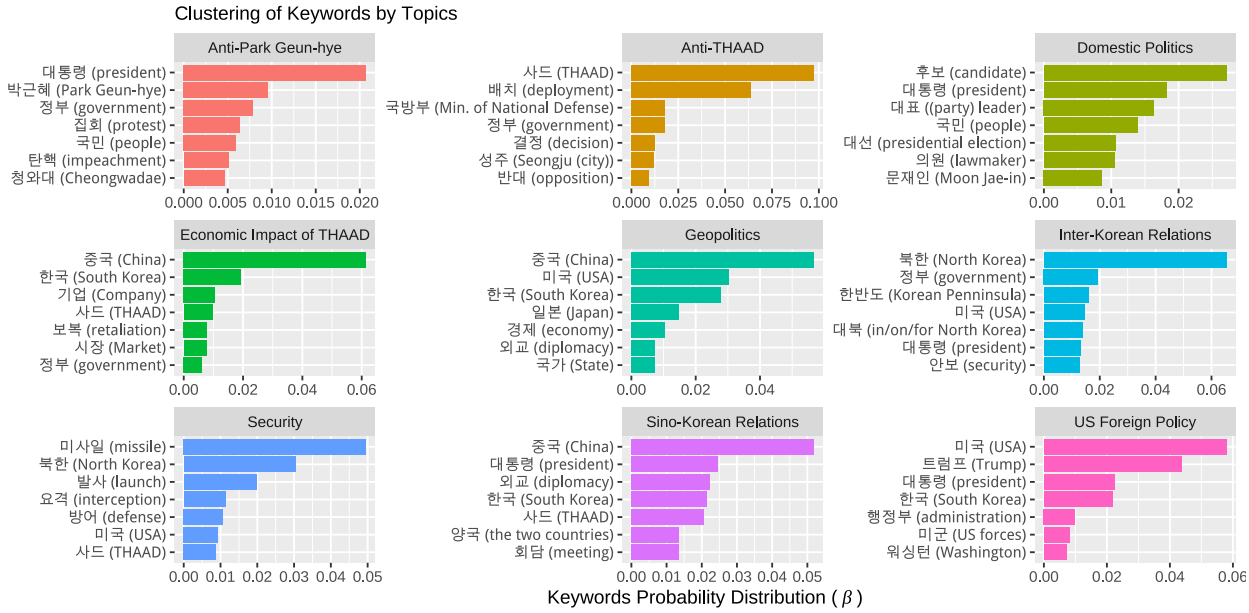
Note: Robust standard errors in parentheses. $^{+}$p<0.1; *p<0.05; **p<0.01; ***p<0.001 .

OA4 Legislator Response to THAAD Deployment

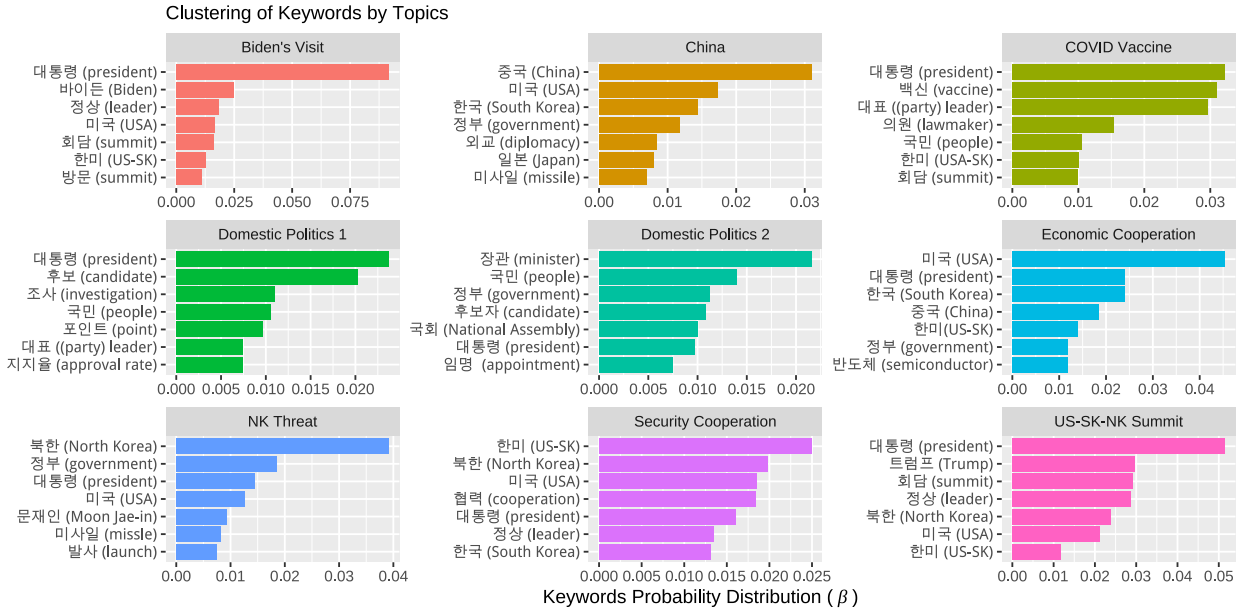
	Dependent variable:		
	Negative	Positive	Neg.-Pos.
	logistic	*logistic*	*ordered logistic*
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Progressive Party	1.879*	−3.360**	−3.044***
	(0.831)	(1.096)	(0.827)
Constant	−2.526***	−0.074	
	(0.741)	(0.388)	
Log Likelihood	−27.721	−23.146	−47.041
Negative|Neutral			−3.661
Neutral|Positive			0.101
Observations	59	59	59

Note: Robust standard errors clustered by legislator in parentheses. Legislator is the unit of analysis. Control variables pertaining to the session and the administration are necessarily excluded. We identified one legislator to have switched between positive and negative stances throughout the period examined. The results are robust to excluding this legislator. *p<0.05; **p<0.01; ***p<0.001

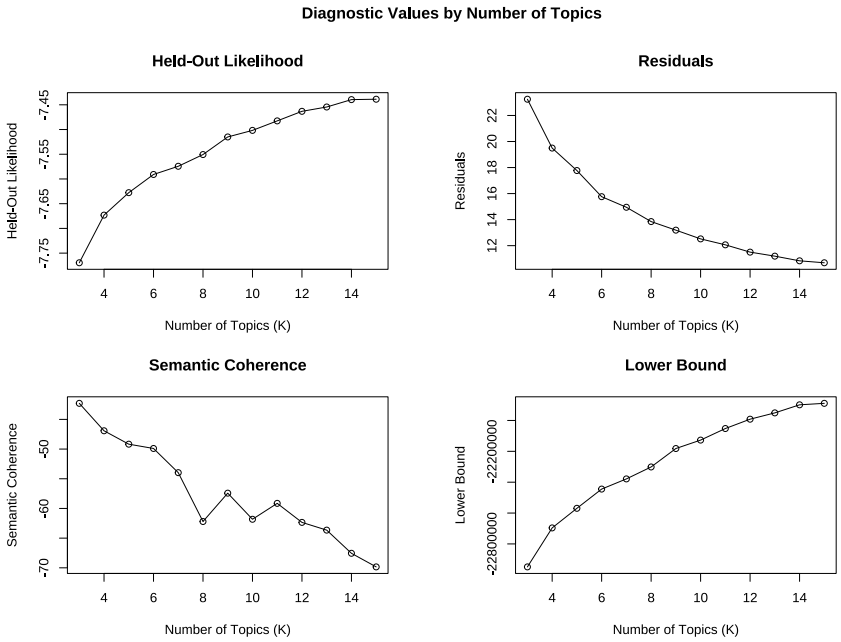
OA5 Keywords Probability Distribution by Topic (THAAD)



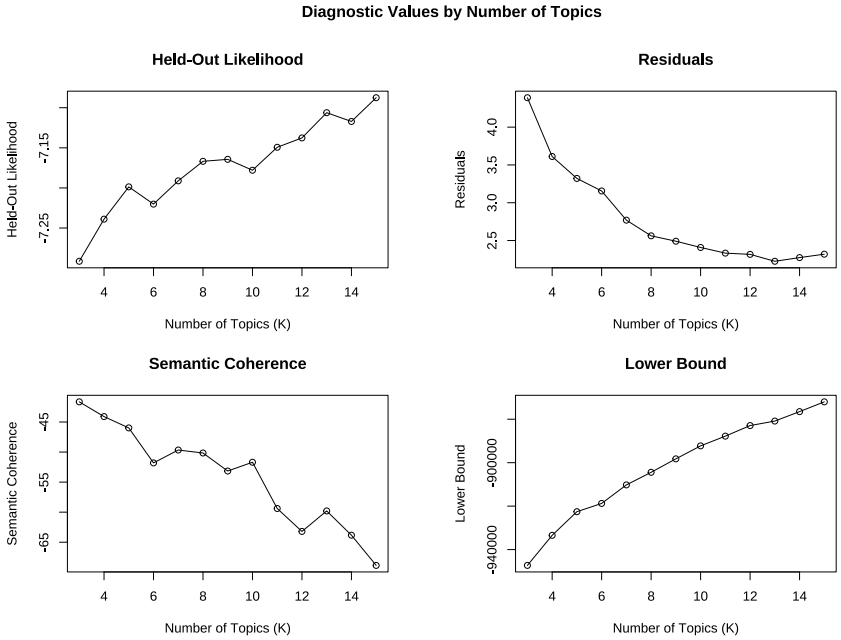
OA6 Keywords Probability Distribution by Topic (US-SK Summit)



OA7 Diagnostic Values by Number of Topics (THAAD)



OA8 Diagnostic Values by Number of Topics (US-SK Summit)



OA9 Top 5 Articles Leveraging Each Topic for *THAAD*

OA9.1 Security

[논설실의 뉴스 읽기] 北 신종미사일, 4분 안에 목표물 타격 방사포와 '섞어 쏘기'땐 속수무책 북한이 지난 4일과 9일 잇따라 4발을 쏜 '북한판 이스칸데르' 미사일에 대한 관심이 높다. 국방부와 군 당국은 북한 신형 미사일이 탄도미사일이라는 사실을 공식 인정하지 않으면서도 최신형 패트리엇 PAC-3 미사일 등으로 요격이 가능하다고 밝히고 있다. 하지만 상당수 전문가는 북 신형 미사일이 종전 북 탄도미사일과는 차원이 다른 '게임 체인저'(Game..

[밀톡]북 미사일 솟구치면 바로 '쾅' 군, 요격 무기 개발한다 [단독] 군 당국이 유사시 북한 탄도미사일을 발사 직후 상승단계에서 KF-X(한국형전투기) 등에서 발사한 고속 미사일(요격탄)로 요격하는 무기를 개발중인 것으로 알려졌다. 미사일 상승 단계에서 요격하면 미사일 파편이 북한 땅 위에 떨어지는 피해가 생길 수 있어 북한의 실제 미사일 발사를 억제하는 효과도 있다. 특히 '북한판 이스칸데르' 미사일 등 요격이 어..

김정은이 설계 끝났다는 핵잠수함, 미 본토 기습 가능 김정은 북한 노동당 위원장이 9일 "새로운 핵잠수함 설계연구가 끝나 최종 심사단계에 있다"며 핵(원자력)추진 잠수함 개발이 이뤄지고 있음을 처음으로 공식 확인했다. 핵추진 잠수함이 건조되면 미국의 대(對)잠수함 전력에 탐지되지 않고 미 본토 근처까지 잠항(潛航)한 뒤 SLBM(잠수함발사탄도미사일)을 발사할 수 있어 기습적인 미 본토 타격능력이 획기적으로..

[박성진의 군 이야기]요격체계 허점 찌른 북 이스칸데르급 미사일 '게임체인저' 되나 1967년 스틱스 샘릿 등 해외 도입으로 시작한 북한 미사일이 변형 유사 탄도미사일인 이스칸데르급 발사 성공으로까지 이어졌다. 대륙간탄도미사일(ICBM)과 잠수함 발사 탄도미사일(SLBM), 북한판 이스칸데르급 미사일 등은 북한의 탄도미사일 '3종 세트'로, 유사시 판을 바꿀 수 있는 게임체인저로 꼽힌다. 한 미 정보당국은 북한의 ICBM은 대기권 재진..

정조대왕함 장착 SM-6... 극초음속 미사일 킬러로 변신한다 지난 28일 진수된 최신예 이지스함 정조대왕함에 우리 해군 함정 중 처음으로 탑재되는 요격미사일 SM-6는 항공기 함정 탄도미사일은 물론 '게임 체인저'로 부상하고 있는 극초음속 미사일도 요격(개량형)할 수 있는 것으로 알려졌다. 극초음속 미사일은 마하 5(음속의 5배) 이상의 초고속으로 적 목표물을 타격할 수 있어 현존 기술로는 탐지 및 요격이 어려운..

OA9.2 Sino-Korean Relations

尹 "中, 북핵해결 건설적 역할을" 시진핑 "방해 배제해야" 美견제 윤석열 대통령과 시진핑(習近平) 중국 국가주석이 한중 수교 30주년인 24일 축하 서한을 통해 정상 간 만남에 대한 의지를 교환했다. 윤 대통령은 이날 서울 종로구 포시즌스호텔에서 열린 수교 30주년 기념 리셉션에서 "한중 관계 발전을 위해 시 주석을 직접 뵙고 협의하길 기대한다"고 대독한 박진 외교부 장관을 통해 밝혔다. 30년 전 수교..

APEC 韓中정상회담 불발 韓中日 정상회의도 올해 넘길듯 윤석열 대통령과 시진핑(習近平 사진) 중국 국가주석의 아시아태평양경제협력체(APEC) 정상회의 참석을 계기로 한중 당국이 정상회담을 추진했지만 결국 불발되면서 최근 양국 관계가 다시 소원해진 것 아니냐는 해석이 나온다. 연내 개최로 추진한 한중일 정상회의도 일단 내년으로 넘어갈 가능성이 높은 것으로 알려졌다. 우리에게 물밑에서 먼저 손을 내밀던 중국이 ..

한반도 문제와 관련 없는 고위급 선택 ·수교 25주년 행사에 정협 부주석 보낸 중국 서열은 높지만 한국과는 별 인연이 없는 비(非)외교계 인사. 한 중 수교 25주년 기념행사에 중국 정부가 보낸 주빈이다. 고고도미사일방어체계(사드) 배치로 냉랭해진 양국 관계를 보여준다. 수교 25주년 기념일인 24일 중국 베이징 중국대반점에서 주중 한국대사관 주최로 열린 행사에는 완강(萬鋼) 인민정치..

문 대통령, 시진핑 주석 당 총서기 연임에 축전 보내 정부 내에 당대회 이후 한 중 관계 개선 기대감 노영민 대사 "중국 입장이 바뀐 것 같은 인상 받았다" 문재인 대통령은 중국 공산당 19차 전국대표대회에서 당 총서기에 연임된 시진핑 중국 국가주석에게 25일 축전을 보내 축하했다. 24일 막을 내린 중국 19차 당대회 이후 한 중 관계가 개선될 수 있다는 기대가 현실화될지 주목된다. 문 대통령은..

여전히 큰 한 중 '사드 시각차' ·새 정부 첫 외교차관 만남 ·정상회담 한반도 정세 논의 ·중 "한국이 결단 보여줘야" 문재인 정부 들어 처음 만난 한 중 외교차관은 양국 관계가 중요한 단계에 와 있으며 소통을 강화해야 한다는 데 의견을 같이했다. 중국 외교 당국자들은 그러나 고고도미사일방어체계(사드) 문제와 관련해선 한국 측에 '정치적 결단'을 촉구했다. 장예쑤이(張業遂..

OA9.3 Anti-THAAD

[한국군 코멘터리]사드 환경평가 논란, 국방부 선후바뀐 '말뚝박기'로 촉발 사드(고고도미사일방어체계) 배치를 둘러싼 각종 논란을 해소하기 위해 구성된 범정부합동TF가 지난 8일 정부서울청사에서 홍남기 국무조정실장이 주재로 첫 회의를 열었다.합동TF는 결론을 도출할 때까지 구체적인 진행 상황은 공개하지 않을 계획인 것으로 전해졌다. 합동TF는 가장 먼저 사드배치 추진과정에서 전략환경영향평가 과정이 생략된 이유를 살펴볼 것으로 보..

사드 배치 속도전 '제동' 정상적 환경평가에 '최장 2년' 문재인 대통령이 5일 사드(THAAD 고고도미사일방어) 배치에 대한 환경영향평가를 회피하려는 국방부의 시도를 확인하고 "법령에 따른 적정한 환경영향평가 절차를 진행하라"고 지시함에 따라, 사드의 정식 배치가 애초 계획보다 늦춰질 가능성이 높아졌다. 또한 '환경영향평가 회피' 방안을 누구의 지시로 마련했는지에 대한 조사가 어디까지 향할지도 관심사로 떠올랐..

청와대 "위승호 국방정책실장이 사드 보고 삭제 지시" 청와대는 5일 사드(고고도미사일방어) 체계 발사대 추가 반입에 관한 국방부의 보고가 누락된 데 대한 진상조사 결과, 위승호 국방부 정책실장이 관련 문구를 청와대 보고서에서 삭제하도록 지시한 것으로 드러났다고 밝혔다. 국방부가 해당 내용을 삭제하고 구두 보고도 하지 않은 행위에 대해 청와

대는 “묵과할 수 없는 사안”이라며 보고 누락 책임 일부가 확인된 위..

사드 환경평가 회피하려 ‘부지 쪼개기’ 꼼수 썼다 국방부가 경북 성주 사드(THAAD 고고도미사일방어) 부지를 주한미군에 제공하면서 ‘전략 환경영향평가’를 받지 않기 위해 법적 기준에 미달하도록 부지 전체를 둘로 나눈 뒤 단계적으로 제공하려 했던 정황이 청와대 조사 결과 확인됐다. 부지 면적이 33만㎡ 이상일 경우 전략 환경영향평가를 받아야 하는 법 규정의 적용을 피하기 위해 전체 70만㎡ 규모인 부지..

성주 주민 반발로 사드 전자파 측정 미뤄 10일 경북 성주에 배치된 사드(THAAD 고고도미사일방어) 체계 레이더의 전자파와 소음을 측정하려던 계획이 또 연기됐다. 지난달 21일에 이어 두번째 미뤄진 것이다. 이진우 국방부 부대변인은 이날 언론 브리핑에서 “주한미군 사드 체계의 배치 문제와 관련해 오늘 계획했던 소규모 환경영향평가 현장조사는 지역 주민 시민단체 등과의 추가적인 협조가 필요..

OA9.4 Geopolitics

[1] [정의길의 세계 그리고] AIIB라는 대륙팽창, 사드라는 해양봉쇄 중국의 아시아인프라투자은행(AIIB)과 미국의 고고도미사일방어체계(사드) 문제를 역사적 관점에서 한번 보자. 대륙세력과 해양세력의 21세기판 격돌이며, 한국은 지금 그 충돌점에 끼여 있다. 유라시아의 역사는 유목세력과 정주세력의 쟁패사다. 초원의 유목세력들과 해안의 정주세력들의 투쟁사다. 고대와 중세까지 대륙의 초원에서 발원한 흉노, 스키타이, 몽골..

[2] AIIB라는 대륙팽창, 사드라는 해양봉쇄 중국의 아시아인프라투자은행(AIIB)과 미국의 고고도미사일방어체계(사드) 문제를 역사적 관점에서 한번 보자. 대륙세력과 해양세력의 21세기판 격돌이며, 한국은 지금 그 충돌점에 끼여 있다. 유라시아의 역사는 유목세력과 정주세력의 쟁패사다. 초원의 유목세력들과 해안의 정주세력들의 투쟁사다. 고대와 중세까지 대륙의 초원에서 발원한 흉노, 스키타이, 몽골 ..

[3] 스탠퍼드 신기욱 “‘국수주의적 포퓰리즘’에 부메랑 맞는다” 신기욱 미국 스탠퍼드대 아시아태평양 연구소장(사회학과 교수)은 역사사회학, 국제정치학에 정통한 재미 석학(碩學)이다. 신 교수는 한미동맹, 동북아 역사, 남북관계 등에 대한 정책 과제를 수행해 미국 워싱턴 정가에서도 지명도가 높다. 그는 2001년 스탠퍼드대 부임과 동시에 한국학 프로그램을 설립했고, 2005년부터 지금까지 동 대학의 아시아태평양 연구..

[4] [쿠오바디스와 행로난] (38) 전쟁, 공포심과 자존심의 잘못된 만남 ㆍ펠로폰네소스 전쟁과 아테네의 몰락 신흥세력에 대한 지배세력의 공포로 인한 세계의 패권 전쟁 ‘투키디데스의 함정’은 이를 경고하는 말. 그러나 공멸에 대한 공포는 전쟁을 막는 힘이기도 하며, 아테네와 스파르타의 자존심이 건드려지지 않았다면 멸망을 향한 전쟁도 없었을 것. 중국과 미국 패권의 ‘밀당’으로 인한 한반도의 공포 상황 양국 대중의 자존심을 ..

[5] [사설] 남중국해 분쟁 중국 완패, 갈등 격화 안 돼야 헤이그 상설중재재판소가 12일 남중국해 일대의 영유권 분쟁과 관련해 필리핀의 손을 들어주고 중국의 주장을 물리치는 예상 밖의 강력한 판결을 내렸다. 남중국해를 둘러싼 미-중 갈등이 새로운 국면으로 옮겨

가게 됐다. 이번 판결에서 가장 눈에 띄는 것은 중국이 남중국해 영유권 주장의 근거로 삼는 '남해 구단선'이 법적 근거가 없다고 판시한 점이다. 남해 ..

OA9.5 Domestic Politics

[1] "이번 대선, 위력적 선거연대는 없다" ▶ 박근혜 대통령에 대한 탄핵 심판이 속도를 냄에 따라 대통령 선거를 향한 움직임도 빨라지고 있습니다. 대선주자들의 출마 선언이 속속 이어지고 있습니다. 주자들의 선거전과 별개로 제3지대론과 빅텐트론 등 후보 연대 움직임도 활발합니다. 이번 대선의 변수와 전망에 대해 정치평론가인 유창선 박사와 정치전략가인 박성민 정치컨설팅민 대표, 여론분석 전문가인 정..

[2] 문재인 대세론 앞에 김종인의 제3지대론? 김종인 전 대표 민주당 탈당 중도 세력 결집 가능성 앞으로 대통령 선거까지 60일 동안 '문재인 후보 대세론'이 주도할 것인가, 아니면 제3지대론이 주도할 것인가. 3월 10일 헌법재판소 탄핵 인용 판결 이후 정치권이 숨가쁘게 돌아가고 있다. 바로 코 앞에 대통령 선거를 두고 있기 때문이다. 지난해 12월 국회에서 탄핵소추안이 통과된 후 민..

[3] 전당대회 오더 경쟁, 친박이 금메달 차지 #1 새누리당 전당대회를 앞두고 8월 7일 치러진 선거인단 투표에서 대구 경북(TK) 출신 책임당원인 ㄱ씨는 투표용지를 놓고 망설였다. 휴대전화 문자메시지와 카톡 메시지를 통해 받은 '오더'는 당대표 선거에서 기호 1번 이정현 후보를 찍으라는 것이었다. 같은 지역 출신인 기호 4번 주호영 후보을 찍으라는 오더였다면 주저 없이 기표를 했겠지만 호남 출신 ..

[4] '역대급 시청률' 첫 TV토론에 여야 '자화자찬' 중도 무당층 표심 흔들릴까 여야는 20대 대선 첫 4자 TV토론에 대해 "우리 후보가 1등"이라며 자화자찬식 평가를 내놨다. 이번 TV토론 시청률이 역대 대선 토론 중 두번째로 높은 39%를 기록하는 등 중도 무당층 표심에 미칠 영향도 주목받았다. 향후 TV토론에선 후보 간 공방이 가열될 수 있다는 전망이 제기된다. 여야는 오는 8일 두번째 4자 TV토론 개최에 합의했다. 송영..

[5] "추미애 '몰아주기'로 강한 야당을" vs "'절대 다수'가 잘못하면 당 망해" 더불어민주당의 전국대의원대회(전대)를 4일 앞둔 지난 23일. 더민주 서울 금천 지역위원회 사무실에는 대의원 40여명이 한자리에 모여 열띤 토론을 벌였다. 이번 전대에서 누구를 당대표로 지지할 것인지가 토론 주제였다. 지역위원장이 대의원 당원들에게 특정 후보를 찍으라고 명령하는, 이른바 '오더'를 '때리지 않겠다'는 의지의 표현일까. 자리를 만든 금천 ..

OA9.6 Economic Impact of THAAD

[1] [강세 토픽] 면세점 테마, 신세계 +6.86%, 호텔신라 +4.53% [면세점] 테마가 강세다. 전일 대비 2.54% 상승세이다. 신세계(004170)+6.86%, 호텔신라(008770)+4.53%, 현대백화점(069960)+0.15% 등이 테마 상승을 이끌고 있다. 테마 설명면세점은 일정 지역을 지정하여, 상품에 부과되는 각종 세금이 유보된 면세상품을 판매하는 곳으로 국가로부터 설치 및 운영 특허를 받아 운영. 매..

[2] [강세 토픽] 면세점 테마, JTC +8.25%, 호텔신라 +4.34% [면세점] 테마가 강세

다. 전일 대비 3.65% 상승세이다. JTC(950170)+8.25%, 호텔신라(008770)+4.34%, 신세계(004170)+1.47% 등이 테마 상승을 이끌고 있다. 테마 설명면세점은 일정 지역을 지정하여, 상품에 부과되는 각종 세금이 유보된 면세상품을 판매하는 곳으로 국가로부터 설치 및 운영 특허를 받아 운영. 매장 ..

[3] [강세 토픽] 면세점 테마, JTC +4.87%, 호텔신라 +2.16% [면세점] 테마가 강세다. 전일 대비 2.01% 상승세이다. JTC(950170)+4.87%, 호텔신라(008770)+2.16%, 신세계(004170)+1.89% 등이 테마 상승을 이끌고 있다. 테마 설명면세점은 일정 지역을 지정하여, 상품에 부과되는 각종 세금이 유보된 면세상품을 판매하는 곳으로 국가로부터 설치 및 운영 특허를 받아 운영. 매장 ..

[4] [강세 토픽] 면세점 테마, JTC +2.49%, 신세계 +2.42% [면세점] 테마가 강세다. 전일 대비 1.86% 상승세이다. JTC(950170)+2.49%, 신세계(004170)+2.42%, 호텔신라(008770)+1.94% 등이 테마 상승을 이끌고 있다. 테마 설명면세점은 일정 지역을 지정하여, 상품에 부과되는 각종 세금이 유보된 면세상품을 판매하는 곳으로 국가로부터 설치 및 운영 특허를 받아 운영. 매장 ..

[5] [강세 토픽] 면세점 테마, JTC +3.58%, 현대백화점 +2.28% [면세점] 테마가 강세다. 전일 대비 2.27% 상승세이다. JTC(950170)+3.58%, 현대백화점(069960)+2.28%, 호텔신라(008770)+2.04% 등이 테마 상승을 이끌고 있다. 테마 설명면세점은 일정 지역을 지정하여, 상품에 부과되는 각종 세금이 유보된 면세상품을 판매하는 곳으로 국가로부터 설치 및 운영 특허를 받아 운영. 매..

OA9.7 Anti-Park Geun-hye

[1] [경향의 눈]박근혜의 자멸과 잊지 못할 이름들 세밑이다. 한 해를 마감하기 사흘 전에 찾은 광화문광장에 부는 바람은 찼다. 하지만 가을 끝자락에서 겨울로 진입하던 때 뜨겁게 달궈졌던 광장의 열기는 칼바람에도 식지 않았다. 작가 최인훈은 "광장은 대중의 밀실이고, 밀실은 개인의 광장이다. 두 공간의 어느 한쪽을 가두어버릴 때 인간은 살 수 없다"고 했다. 그가 옳았다. 광장의 촛불은 밀실의 어둠을 몰..

[2] [강내희 칼럼] 쾌지나 칭칭 나네 강내희 지식순환협동조합 대안대학 학장 "박근혜가 쫓겨나네, 쾌지나 칭칭 나네. 새 시대를 열어보세, 쾌지나 칭칭 나네. 신자유주의 끝장내고, 쾌지나 칭칭 나네. 헬조선도 몰아내고, 쾌지나 칭칭 나네. 민주평등 공공성, 쾌지나 칭칭 나네. 새 공화국 세워보세, 쾌지나 칭칭 나네." 이런 내용의 노래를 크게 부르고 싶은 것은 수많은 사람들로 하여금 "이..

[3] "박근혜 없는 봄, 덕분입니다" 처음 본 옆 사람과 함께 자축 "여러분이 바로 승리의 주인공입니다!" 11일 저녁 서울 종로구 광화문광장 촛불집회 사회를 맡은 박진 박근혜정권퇴진비상국민행동(퇴진행동) 상황실장의 함성이 울려퍼졌다. 촛불 시민들도 환호성을 올렸다. 승리를 기념하는 폭죽이 하늘을 수놓았다. 시민들은 '촛불의 승리'를 자축하며 옆에 앉은 생면부지의 사람에게 "수고했다", "덕분입니다" 인사를 건넸다...

[4] [11 12 민중총궐기 라이브-2탄] 시대의 어둠을 밝히는 촛불 든 두 소녀 ■13일 03시50분 : 경찰, 경복궁역 인근 집회 연행 나서 노동당 차량 압류팩트TV의 실시간 중계에 따르면 오전 3시30분 현재 경찰들이 연좌농성 중인 시민들을 연행하는 과정에서 집회 참가자들과 격한 몸싸움이 벌어졌다. 이 과정에서 한 시민이 부상을 입어 3시40분쯤 응급차에 실려 가기도 했다. 현장에 남아있는 약 1000여명의 시민들은 '폭력경찰 ..

[5] [12 10촛불집회]"이젠 박근혜의 정책을 탄핵할 때" 추위속에도 꺼지지 않는 춘천 촛불 "이젠 박근혜의 정책을 탄핵할 때 입니다."10일 오후 5시 20분 강원 춘천시 석사동 김진태 의원 사무실 인근에서 열린 '춘천 촛불 시국 대회'엔 쌀쌀한 날씨에도 불구하고 주최측 추산으로 1000여명(경찰 추산 400여명)의 시민들이 몰려들었다.집회 장소로 가는 길목 곳곳엔 '헬조선 악의축, 독점재벌 해체', '박근혜 적폐 청산' 등의 문구가 담긴 현..

OA9.8 Inter-Korean Relations

[1] [사설]남북관계를 냉전시대로 돌려놓은 보수정권 8년 이명박 박근혜 보수정권은 지난 8년 동안 남북관계의 좌표를 180도 돌려놓았다. 대화 교류에서 단절로, 화해 협력에서 대결로 바꾸면서 과거 냉전시대로 몰아갔다. 두 정권이 김대중 노무현 정권이 공들여 쌓아놓은 유 무형의 남북관계 자산을 다 까먹은 것이다. 남북 신뢰는 금이 갔고 그 자리를 불신이 채우고 있다. 금강산관광이 중단됐고, 개성공단은 문을 닫았..

[2] 즉흥적이고, 통찰력 없고, 구호만 요란 ·뉴스분석 - 박근혜 정부 3년 '남북관계 단절' 원인 3가지 개성공단 폐쇄로 박근혜 정부 대북정책에 대한 비판 여론이 커지고 있다. 북한 4차 핵실험과 장거리 로켓(미사일) 발사 등 김정은 정권의 폭주가 한반도 신냉전 구도를 촉발했지만, 정부도 원칙 일관성을 상실한 '우왕좌왕 대북정책'으로 북한을 관리하지 못하고 상황을 악화시켰다는 것이다. '통일..

[3] 정부 성명 "한미동맹 실질조처 추진 대북 압박 계속" 정부는 7일 북한의 로켓 발사 뒤 박근혜 대통령 주재로 소집한 국가안전보장회의(NSC) 뒤 발표한 '정부 성명'에서 "우리의 안보 능력을 강화시키기 위해 한 미 동맹 차원의 실질적인 조치를 추진해나가겠다"밝혔다. 정부는 회의 뒤 조태용 국가안보실 1차장 겸 NSC 사무처장이 춘추관에서 발표한 '정부 성명'을 통해 "정부와 국제사회는 6자회담 등 여러..

[4] [사설] 북핵 문제에 궤변 변명 무대책으로 일관한 대통령 연설 박근혜 대통령이 어제 국회 연설을 통해 북한 핵 로켓 도발 대응 방안을 밝히고, 개성공단 전면 중단 조치의 배경을 설명했다. 더불어 국민 단합을 요청하고 국회에 테러방지법 등 쟁점법안 통과를 주문했다. 대통령은 안보 위기를 맞아 국민과 정치권에 대책을 제시하고 협조를 요청할 수 있다. 하지만 박 대통령의 연설은 북한의 4차 핵실험과 장거리 로켓 발사로

[5] 대북제재 "시작에 불과" 밝혔지만 더 쓸 '수단'이 없다 박근혜 대통령이 16일 국회 연설에서 밝힌 북한의 핵실험 로켓발사 대응의 기조 목표 수단은 단순하다. 국제사회와의 공조로 압박 제재를 강화 지속해 "북한 정권이 핵개발로는 체제 붕괴를 재촉할 뿐이라는 사실을 깨닫고 스스로 변화할 수밖에 없는 환경"을 만들겠다는 것이다. 이 논리를 연장하면, 북한이 핵을 포기하지 않으면 정권 붕괴 때까지 몰아붙이겠다는 얘..

OA9.9 US Foreign Policy

[1] "빈살만 왕세자는 사이코패스 백부 국왕 죽이려 했다" 사우디아라비아 정보국 전직 고위 간부가 무함마드 빈 살만 사우디 왕세자(36 사진)를 두고 '감정 없는 사이코패스(반사회성 성격장애)'라고 했다. 또 무함마드 왕세자가 2014년에는 당시 국왕인 큰아버지 압둘라 빈 압둘아지즈 알 사우드를 죽이고 아버지의 즉위를 앞당기고 싶어 했다고 주장했다. 무함마드 왕세자는 사우디를 실질적으로 통치하는 권력자다. 무함..

[2] 레바논 총리 "이란 내정간섭" 주장 사임 배후는 사우디? 사드 하리리 레바논 총리가 사우디아라비아 방문 중에 이란의 내정간섭을 비판하며 전격 사임했다. 사우디와 이란, 미국의 갈등이 첨예해지고 있는 가운데, 레바논 총리 사임의 배후에 사우디가 있다는 분석이 나오며 레바논이 중동 갈등의 새 불씨가 될 수 있다는 우려가 커지고 있다. 외신을 보면 4일 하리리 레바논 총리는 사우디 방문 중 텔레비전 연설을 통..

[3] IS 격퇴한 이라크 시리아 빠진 '범이슬람대테러연맹' 사우디 왕세자의 속내는 사우디아라비아의 무함마드 빈살만 왕세자가 대테러전을 위한 중동의 연합체를 구성하고 극단주의와의 전쟁을 선포했다. 자신의 리더십은 세속적 왕권이라는 이미지를 강화하는 한편 지역 내 반이란 전선을 공고히 하려는 움직임으로 보인다. 사우디의 무함마드를 포함한 41개 이슬람 국가 국방장관은 26일(현지시간) 사우디 수도 리야드에서 이슬람대테러군사동맹(IMCT..

[4] "사우디 왕세자, 삼촌인 국왕 독반지로 암살 가능 자랑" 사우디아라비아의 실세인 무함마드 빈 살만 왕세자가 과거 왕위에 오르기 전 아버지의 권력을 강화하기 위해 삼촌인 국왕을 암살할 수 있다고 자랑했다는 증언이 나왔다. 사우디 정보기관의 이인자였던 사드 알자브리는 24일(현지시간) 미국 CBS 방송 인터뷰에서 무함마드 왕세자가 2014년 러시아에서 입수한 독반지를 갖고 있다면서 "나는 국왕을 암살하고 싶다..

[5] 이라크 시리아 빠진 '범이슬람연합' 사우디 왕세자 속내는 ·IS 맞서 41개국 첫 회의 소집 ·사실상 이란 견제용 지적 급진적 이미지 벗기 의도도 사우디아라비아의 무함마드 빈살만 왕세자가 대테러전을 위한 중동의 연합체를 구성하고 극단주의와의 전쟁을 선포했다. 세속적 왕권이라는 이미지를 강화하는 한편 지역 내 반이란 전선을 공고히 하려는 움직임으로 보인다. 41개 이슬람 국가 국방장관은 26일(현지시간..